Bias Bounty Mapping Equity Challenge — final methodology and discovery writeup

• Competition: bias-bounty-mapping-equity-challenge (Zindi)

• Lane: comp-zindi-bias-bounty

• Writeup revision: git f68250776cd76e890d2cf0ab6dcc6df1ca4ddfbd (tree clean: False)

• Zindi username or team name: **PENDING_OPERATOR_CONFIRMATION**

• Operator confirmation of that identity recorded: NO — pending operator

• Form submission status: **NOT SUBMITTED — staged for operator submission**

• Protocol final-two candidates (operator confirmation pending): V2_model_cgs and B_from_A_cgs (protocol outcome; operator confirmation pending)

• Zindi UI selection: **NOT CONFIRMED by the operator; no UI selection was made**.

• Official requirement: Your writeup should identify your Zindi username or team name and the leaderboard submission(s) associated with the methodology.

• Packaged for the organiser writeup form; form URL status: NOT AVAILABLE in the saved rules text

Scored scope: 9379 official tracts across four regions (2814 public / 6565 private expected), uploaded on the platform template of 9794 rows including 415 template-only rows.

Current model candidate presented in this writeup: V2_model at reports/candidates/V2_model.csv (SHA-256 3193ee78a64004f007829f1f9c12d4aa8d4f7c15136771e8da9108fdcea06f12), 9794 rows. The original five-column V2 upload is void for selection because Zindi scored its transport_gap column. The frozen A rule selected V2_model_cgs from the four successful corrected-order _cgs scores (public RMSE 0.11102814; submission hvLtPVmr). B_from_A_cgs is its pre-registered 50% shrink companion (public RMSE 0.097535343; submission eAaWXWxM); B's score was not used to select A. Operator confirmation of the final-two choice and Zindi UI selection remain pending; no form was submitted.

Correctly ordered format-only platform artifact: V2_model_cgs at reports/candidates/V2_model_cgs.csv (SHA-256 5d0607d5531793008d8d5c86b1625f26e5bb8e9504a2b4a4a84f0224a0f5cef7). Its coverage_gap_score values are copied byte-for-byte from the frozen model candidate above; no prediction was changed.

Protocol result: A is V2_model_cgs (submission hvLtPVmr, public RMSE 0.11102814, SHA-256 5d0607d5531793008d8d5c86b1625f26e5bb8e9504a2b4a4a84f0224a0f5cef7); B is B_from_A_cgs (submission eAaWXWxM, public RMSE 0.097535343, SHA-256 38e17cf1ec99f4f3fc5d358d13ccd0edfabe947d81fd6b6e5ef61e6cea006607). The frozen A rule used only the four successful corrected-order _cgs cohort scores; V2_model_cgs won outside each pairwise noise guard. B is the pre-registered fixed companion and its score was not used to select A. The operator must review the discovery narrative and confirm the final-two/UI choice before any form submission.

Column-order correction and historical score eligibility

The per-region sample files use GEOID,transport_gap,building_gap,poi_gap,coverage_gap_score, while the Data-page SampleSubmission.csv starts GEOID,coverage_gap_score. Zindi scores the second CSV column by position, so every earlier five-column public score measured transport_gap, not coverage_gap_score. Those historical scores and submission records are retained for auditability but are void for candidate selection and are not used to tune or change predictions. Each registered _cgs.csv copies the frozen coverage_gap_score text unchanged into the Data-page two-column order. No corrected-format upload occurs before 2026-10-29 00:00 UTC.

Final A/B IDs, hashes and public scores below are sourced from reports/final-two.json and are checked against the submission records. The broader claim-to-evidence audit has unresolved items, disclosed in the reproducibility appendix; this draft is not yet approved for submission. No historical platform score is evidence about the intended composite target.

> *The saved official page text in the workspace RULES.md preserves the sentence but not the hyperlink target, so the operator must supply the form URL; this build never guesses one.*

Prize consideration requested

We request consideration for both Best Bias Discovery ($1,000) and Best Documentation ($500).

Best Bias Discovery entry — Best Bias Discovery ($1,000)

• Prize: Best Bias Discovery ($1,000).

• Official note: Entries for Best Bias Discovery are judged from the writeup by the organizing team against four criteria

• Judging criteria and weights (official text):

• Impact: 30%.

• Novelty: 25%.

• Evidence: 25%.

• Reproducibility: 20%.

• Tie-break: Ties are broken by earlier submission.

Best Documentation entry — Best Documentation ($500)

• Prize: Best Documentation ($500).

• Official note: No separate leaderboard submission is required for Best Bias Discovery or Best Documentation.

Leaderboard submission records and score eligibility

Historical five-column uploads placed transport_gap second, so their returned public values are preserved as records but void for A/B selection. The _cgs rows use GEOID,coverage_gap_score; the four cohort scores were used only by the frozen A rule, which selected the final A shown below; the B companion score was excluded from A selection. No public score is used to alter a candidate value.

Platform submission id	Candidate	Artifact	Artifact SHA-256	Public RMSE	Split	Score source	Selection eligibility	Uploaded (UTC)
uRRw9KpB	C0	reports/candidates/C0_all_zero.csv	0edf8140123e2135489e5728fd71bce6f1e28a97f447ca411ba45fdbc02bc214	0.107246299	public	zindi_api_status	void for selection: five-column file had transport_gap in column 2	2026-10-24T09:18:02+00:00
BvyKrR6v	C1	reports/candidates/C1_region_constants.csv	dc2e368194b31408cb5c313fa8ce3f3fa59a1b5965bc2df8e4217bbc9e0c82e0	0.146449112	public	zindi_api_status	void for selection: five-column file had transport_gap in column 2	2026-10-24T09:18:25+00:00

Platform submission id	Candidate	Artifact	Artifact SHA-256	Public RMSE	Split	Score source	Selection eligibility	Uploaded (UTC)
rTARuUaG	C2	reports/candidates/C2_component_estimator_v0.csv	5728fbbaa2e062fbd14199190a260132c95b2b858da539d7a9580cb2abc62514	0.23535871 2	public	zindi_api_status	void for selection: five-column file had transport_gap in column 2	2026-10-24T09:19:08+00:00
TM83xxU6	C3	reports/candidates/C3_denominator_x125.csv	e5ee50f5c2cca149550f3408638d2b77431f6ed62cf104dfe8c07d8c84166f9e4	0.34940986 7	public	zindi_api_status	void for selection: five-column file had transport_gap in column 2	2026-10-24T09:19:54+00:00
ySXi73rd	P4	reports/candidates/P4_c1_shrink_alpha.csv	8b329802d882ea4bdff2bfd8c465c160d6ffd9269cfbe28dce8be9e702b07d37	0.09144019 8	public	zindi_api_status	void for selection: five-column file had transport_gap in column 2	2026-10-24T09:38:39+00:00
iQw8C6Q9	A1_physical_equal	reports/candidates/A1_physical_equal.csv	6af088b83ff3481d420e11b14d903fc510c2b4be2cea285c762ca12d500862de	0.12654354 7	public	zindi_api_status	void for selection: five-column file had transport_gap in column 2	2026-10-26T14:23:12+00:00

Platform submission id	Candidate	Artifact	Artifact SHA-256	Public RMSE	Split	Score source	Selection eligibility	Uploaded (UTC)
W83LEghZ	A2_spectral	reports/candidates/A2_spectral.csv	f88573996566a1975726845a49f42fb2cd3781d5f0e83d55944fc65647692997	0.14608951 3	public	zindi_api_status	void for selection: five-column file had transport_gap in column 2	2026-10-26T14:23:12+00:00
tGB6sGRx	A3_dawid_skene	reports/candidates/A3_dawid_skene.csv	6d588f2f7a45a58b128860a049ac19995b21902f7f98d3b2ab39d1d9fbb073b3	0.14608951 3	public	zindi_api_status	void for selection: five-column file had transport_gap in column 2	2026-10-27T00:19:00+00:00
EbwLNkmt	V2_model	reports/candidates/V2_model.csv	3193ee78a64004f007829f1f9c12d4aa8d4f7c15136771e8da9108fdcea06f12	0.12164459 6	public	zindi_api_status	void for selection: five-column file had transport_gap in column 2	2026-10-27T00:19:00+00:00
hvLtPVmr	V2_model_cgs	reports/candidates/V2_model_cgs.csv	5d0607d5531793008d8d5c86b1625f26e5bb8e9504a2b4a4a84f0224a0f5cef7	0.11102814	public	zindi_api_status	selected A by frozen corrected-order_cgs rule	2026-10-28T07:15:46.098Z

Platform submission id	Candidate	Artifact	Artifact SHA-256	Public RMSE	Split	Score source	Selection eligibility	Uploaded (UTC)
4R4vkHSd	A1_physical_equal_cgs	reports/candidates/A1_physical_equal_cgs.csv	2da0051af221ddf26a8a73740746811dbd956854a1fc12846c99864d3abae8a1	0.309628459	public	zindi_api_status	corrected-order_cgs A-rule cohort; not selected as A	2026-10-28T07:15:51.544Z
s7mXS43p	A2_spectral_cgs	reports/candidates/A2_spectral_cgs.csv	584e086bb5df950f6079317afcdc7c5a0182b5263d170be2a10987d1ac4c6213	0.26257881	public	zindi_api_status	corrected-order_cgs A-rule cohort; not selected as A	2026-10-28T07:16:00.493Z
B8de77WD	A3_dawid_skene_cgs	reports/candidates/A3_dawid_skene_cgs.csv	432ade8f1e46c6804cb34fb790612bb1befc9fe03b67a545e753be46b549237c	0.15224784	public	zindi_api_status	corrected-order_cgs A-rule cohort; not selected as A	2026-10-29T00:10:29.255Z
eAaWXWxM	B_from_A_cgs	reports/candidates/B_from_A_cgs.csv	38e17cf1ec99f4f3fc5d358d13ccd0edfabe947d81fd6b6e5ef61e6cea006607	0.097535343	public	zindi_api_status	pre-registered B companion; score excluded from A selection	2026-10-29T00:12:18.199Z

The scored methodology candidate in this writeup is V2_model, built from provided features only (commit b45733aa31903c71ec4f3fb432c2bc9d519f3ff9). The original five-column V2 upload is void for selection because Zindi scored its transport_gap column. The frozen A rule selected V2_model_cgs from the four successful corrected-order _cgs scores (public RMSE 0.11102814; submission hvLtPVmr). B_from_A_cgs is its pre-registered 50% shrink companion (public RMSE 0.097535343; submission eAaWXWxM); B's score was not used to select A. Operator confirmation of the final-two choice and Zindi UI selection remain pending; no form was submitted. Its predicted public RMSE is 0.091357195976378675 on the stated model-side moments of the frozen artifact (mu_v, sd_v, E[v^2]) with the all-zero candidate C0 platform RMSE as the E[y^2] anchor, assumed target mean equal to the model's own mean and assumed centred correlation 0.3; no LB-derived model parameter basis, which is a model-side forecast, not a leaderboard observation.

The earlier five-column uploads above are retained as historical calibration records for auditability. Their column-2 scores measured transport_gap and are void for selection; the correctly ordered _cgs evaluations are separately labeled, and no score value, fitted constant or probe outcome is used to change any candidate prediction or discovery claim.

Final-two protocol outcome: A=V2_model_cgs / hvLtPVmr (0.11102814); B=B_from_A_cgs / eAaWXWxM (0.097535343). A was selected from exactly four corrected-order _cgs scores; unique winner V2_model_cgs exceeded all pairwise noise guards. B is the pre-registered companion, not an A-rule competitor. Operator UI/form confirmation remains pending.

Best Bias Discovery entry

Best Bias Discovery: post-fire building-count disagreement may look like under-mapping

Status: the post-fire disagreement and Overture source-provenance findings below use challenge-provided inputs; additional public context layers are screened in Section 4 under the discovery-prize data policy. None is a claim about hidden organiser scores, the exact reference vintage, or measured emergency outcomes. The high-burn versus unburned direction is repeatable, but its quantitative size is exploratory once counties rather than tracts are resampled, as recorded below.

Impact

In a set of six Butte County tracts in the Paradise/Magalia Camp Fire focus identified by the discovery brief, the provided Overture building count is 0.620–0.747 of the provided USFS Wildfire-Risk-to-Communities usfs_BuildingCount_sum. The provided MTBS attributes report a 2018 last-burn year for all six. The six tracts' provided pop_total sums to 6,977; this is a tract-population total, not a count of people confirmed displaced or affected.

If emergency or recovery planners interpret a building-count comparison as current map completeness when the reference still reflects pre-fire structures, destroyed structures can appear to be unmapped buildings. That mismatch could distort address inventories, dispatch geocoding, evacuation planning, or recovery-resource estimates. These are plausible risks, not observed dispatch failures or evidence about which source is operationally current. Fixed rural/wildfire strata alone cannot distinguish stale reference structures from genuine missing current map features.

Novelty

This is a temporal source-provenance interaction: post-fire burn history is associated with disagreement between two provided building summaries. It is not simply a marginal rural, wildfire-risk, or SVI comparison. The result is consistent with the organizer's example class of post-disaster rebuilt areas and source behavior, but does not establish that the hidden score uses the USFS field or that it labels these tracts as coverage gaps.

Evidence

The comparison is exactly Overture overture_buildings / provided strata usfs_BuildingCount_sum; ratio <0.8 is a descriptive cutoff, not an organiser score. The table below comes from the authoritative 591-row NorCal sample. Camp Fire names are contextual labels supplied with the discovery lead; the provided columns themselves identify GEOIDs, county, burn percentage, and last-burn year, not fire incident names.

Butte County GEOID	Overture / provided USFS count	Provided MTBS burned %	Last burn year	pop_total
06007001800	0.620	100.0	2018	840
06007002100	0.643	100.1	2018	926
06007002000	0.662	100.0	2018	886
06007001900	0.677	100.3	2018	675
06007002300	0.720	64.4	2018	1,851
06007002200	0.747	153.8	2018	1,799

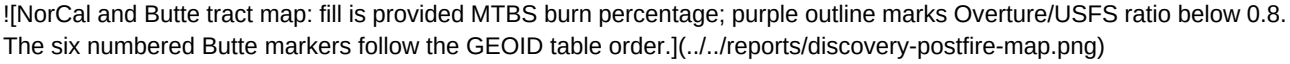
The stronger stale-reference interpretation was directly tested using public Camp Fire DINS evidence; it did not meet the registered mechanism criteria. The bounded DINS follow-up and its claim pointers are at the end of this discovery section.

Two additional supplied examples are 06089010603 (ratio 0.691; MTBS last burn 2018) and 06033000704 (0.798; last burn 2017). The provided cumulative burned-area percentage can exceed 100 after repeated burns; values above 100 are kept in the named examples but excluded from the mutually exclusive 0–100% burn-class comparison.

Provided NorCal burn class	Tracts	Ratio <0.8	Share below 0.8
0% (unburned)	449	7	1.6%
>0–5%	28	0	0.0%
>5–20%	32	0	0.0%
>20–<50%	32	0	0.0%
50–100%	36	4	11.1%

Fourteen of 591 tracts have provided burned percentages above 100 and are excluded from these bins; none are missing a burn percentage. The high-burn minus unburned difference is **+9.55 percentage points**, and its 95% percentile interval is **[+0.55, +20.89] percentage points** under the published stratified 50,000-draw tract bootstrap but **[-1.65, +16.67] percentage points** when whole counties are resampled instead of tracts; under the criterion preregistered before any result was seen, the difference is therefore **exploratory** and is not established at 95% confidence. The two intervals answer different questions and are not interchangeable: the tract interval measures sensitivity to tract-level resampling of the binary ratio indicator at a fixed county composition, and because tracts inside one county share Overture provider mix, terrain and reference vintage it understates county-level dependence, so it is not the interval to quote when counties rather than tracts are the independent units; it also captures none of the spatial dependence, measurement error, source-vintage uncertainty, or hidden-target error. Butte County has 54 sample tracts, six below the ratio cutoff; their summed pop_total is 6,977.

That published interval resamples tracts independently. Tracts inside one county share Overture provider mix, terrain and reference vintage, so it understates county-level dependence, and the same statistic was rechecked with a county-cluster bootstrap that was preregistered before any result was seen (reports/discovery-postfire-county-bootstrap.json, scripts/audit_discovery_postfire_county_bootstrap.py): 50,000 seeded replicates resample all 23 counties of the analysis population with replacement, every tract record of a selected county is kept, and the difference is recomputed inside each replicate. The point estimate is unchanged, every replicate contained both focal groups (valid-replicate fraction 1.0), and 95.99% of valid replicates point the same way, but the 95% percentile interval widens from [+0.55, +20.89] to [-1.65, +16.67] percentage points, so its lower bound is no longer above zero. Under the preregistered criterion the quantitative difference is therefore **exploratory**: the direction is repeatable in almost every county resample, while this sample does not support it at 95% confidence once counties, rather than tracts, are treated as the independent units. The widening is not the artefact of one influential county: dropping any single county one at a time leaves the point difference between +5.56 and +10.71 percentage points, and the 36 high-burn tracts sit in 15 of the 23 counties. This remains a descriptive statement about disagreement between two provided layers; it does not establish cause, and it is not evidence that either layer is wrong, that any map is stale, or that any response or service differs.



Source/vintage caution: the compared count is the provided strata field usfs_BuildingCount_sum; its supplied edition metadata is recorded in reports/discovery-postfire.json. The observed ratios support the hypothesis that a 2018-vintage Microsoft-footprint derivative may be stale after wildfire, leaving a risk-building count above the Overture count. The tract-level analysis does not independently verify the supplied count's exact vintage. It does **not** claim that the organiser used a 2018 Microsoft release or this USFS field to construct its hidden target.

Reproducibility

The script scripts/discovery_postfire_stale_reference.py reads the provided NorCal Overture feature cache, only selected fields from the provided strata table, GEOID values from the official sample, and GEOID/geometry columns from the challenge-provided ACS geometry object. It does not read placeholder scores, labels, removed reference layers, or DINS/external evidence. The script reproduces the ratio table, burn-class table, bootstrap CI, Butte population sum, and map; the deterministic report is reports/discovery-postfire.json, and the map is reports/discovery-postfire-map.png. The county-cluster recheck is a separate deterministic script with its own preregistered configuration, scripts/audit_discovery_postfire_county_bootstrap.py, whose report is reports/discovery-postfire-county-bootstrap.json:

```
COMPETITION_WORKSPACE="$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ /home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --quiet \ --with
numpy==2.5.4 --with pyarrow==26.0.0 \ python scripts/audit_discovery_postfire_county_bootstrap.py \
--workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out reports/discovery-postfire-county-bootstrap.json
```

Two runs of that command produced byte-identical reports, and the audit fails closed if a county is missing from the resampling pool, if the resampled clusters are not whole counties, or if the writeup fails to state the robustness verdict; it re-runs the published tract-level design as a reference control and reproduces its frozen interval exactly, and it never re-tunes the ratio cutoff or drops a county. No scored candidate CSV was changed; their hashes are captured in the report.

From the competition repository with the authorized workspace and network access to the provided challenge geometry object:

```
MPLCONFIGDIR=/tmp/zindi-bias-bounty-mplconfig \ /home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run \ --with pyarrow
--with numpy --with matplotlib --with shapely --with pyproj \ python
scripts/discovery_postfire_stale_reference.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out
reports/discovery-postfire.json \ --map reports/discovery-postfire-map.png
```

A repeated run produced byte-identical JSON and PNG in the recorded environment for this provided-data analysis; it uses no external data. The separate public DINS mechanism test above is documented in reports/discovery-dins-mechanism.md and its workspace manifest, and does not alter this base analysis or any scored candidate. All statements about emergency-planning consequences are hypothetical, and the pattern is descriptive rather than causal.

Section 2 — Scorecard strata are strongly region-composition confounded

Impact

An all-region tribal-versus-non-tribal or rural-versus-urban comparison can be mistaken for a coverage disparity when its groups have very different regional composition. That can misdirect mapping audits or investment: an apparent tribal “priority” could largely track Eastern Oklahoma rather than represent tribal communities across regions, while the much larger non-tribal group mostly represents South-Central Texas. If regional road-taxonomy differences affect the road metric, that artifact could likewise divert route-mapping work from communities with actual access needs. These are plausible decision risks, not observed dispatch failures or evidence of a true coverage gap.

Novelty

The automated scorecard reports marginal tribal and rural comparisons but does not make region composition the comparison itself. The provided sample shows that tribal_any is nearly an Eastern Oklahoma indicator, while the non-tribal comparison is dominated by Texas. The official rules also warn that Overture/TIGER named-road length ratios vary from 0.71 to 1.59 across regions because primary/secondary conventions differ. Those facts make a pooled road-equity result vulnerable to both stratum-mix and taxonomy effects. They do not establish the size or direction of a hidden-score disparity.

Evidence

The script joins only official sample GEOIDs to the provided tribal_any and pct_urban strata. Composition cells below are tract count (% of that row's stratum); the sample row is the 9,379-tract denominator. Rural is strictly pct_urban < 0.5, urban is >=0.5.

Stratum	Total	Eastern OK	Maricopa AZ	Northern CA	South-Central TX
All official sample tracts	9,379	1,192 (12.71%)	1,593 (16.98%)	591 (6.30%)	6,003 (64.00%)
tribal_any = true	858	805 (93.82%)	37 (4.31%)	15 (1.75%)	1 (0.12%)
tribal_any = false	8,521	387 (4.54%)	1,556 (18.26%)	576 (6.76%)	6,002 (70.44%)
Rural, pct_urban < 0.5	1,712	411 (24.01%)	163 (9.52%)	147 (8.59%)	991 (57.89%)
Urban, pct_urban >= 0.5	7,641	780 (10.21%)	1,419 (18.57%)	444 (5.81%)	4,998 (65.41%)

Within-region tribal prevalence is 67.53% in Eastern Oklahoma, 2.32% in Maricopa, 2.54% in Northern California, and 0.017% in South-Central Texas. The official sample contains 858 tribal_any tracts, of which 805 (93.82%) are in Eastern Oklahoma; 6,002 of 8,521 non-tribal tracts (70.44%) are in South-Central Texas. Thus a pooled tribal contrast is also a comparison of sharply different region mixtures. The rural group is less concentrated but still 57.89% Texas; 26 official tracts have missing pct_urban and were excluded rather than imputed.

The earlier backlog measurement listed rural counts of 412/174/147/1,005 for Oklahoma/Arizona/California/Texas. Those counts equal the strict threshold counts above plus the corresponding missing pct_urban rows (1/11/0/14). A missing value is not <0.5, so this report does not silently treat it as rural. Input paths, hashes, exact selected columns, counts and the region-composition table are in reports/discovery-strata-confound.json.

The rules disclose a 0.71–1.59 cross-region Overture/TIGER named-road ratio range but do not map the endpoints to individual regions. The completed provided-Overture route audit (reports/transport-route-ref-audit.json) measures sum(L_named)/sum(L_route) as 1.929 in Maricopa, 1.504 in Northern California, 1.161 in Eastern Oklahoma, and 1.183 in South-Central Texas; the lane's broader 0.6–1.7 acceptance band is met in three regions, with Maricopa remaining high under the declared route-network filter. These are aggregate taxonomy diagnostics only: they use no TIGER observations, labels, LB feedback, or per-tract hidden scores and do not identify which regions correspond to the organizer's undisclosed ratio endpoints. The earlier statement that route ratios were unavailable is superseded by this audit; the Maricopa filter/coverage limitation remains documented there.

Reproducibility

scripts/discovery_strata_confound.py reads only GEOID from each official sample CSV and GEOID, tribal_any, and pct_urban from each provided strata Parquet. It excludes the seven Texas strata rows outside the official sample and does not use sample score-placeholder values, candidate scores, labels, external data, or removed road references. Reproduce with:

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --with pyarrow==26.0.0 \ python
scripts/discovery_strata_confound.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out
reports/discovery-strata-confound.json
```

The script asserts 9,379 unique official IDs and deterministic cohort accounting. A repeated run produced byte-identical JSON. This establishes composition confounding in the provided sample; it does not estimate hidden coverage scores or validate the scorecard's accuracy.

Secondary exploratory lead — rural × SVI minority-domain screen in South-Central Texas

Draft for operator review; not a claim about true organiser scores. The competition has no training labels, and the reference layers used to calculate the hidden target are removed. Every score below is a C2/C3 provided-data proxy. The analysis identifies a subgroup for follow-up; it does not establish an observed real-world mapping disparity or causation.

Proposed pattern outside the published scorecard grid

The official scorecard description lists five equity metrics across separate dimensions such as rural/urban, SVI, CVI, tribal status, and hazard exposure. It does not specify a joint cell for rural tracts in the upper quartile of the provided svi_minority domain field. This draft examines that intersection within the South-Central Texas sample, rather than restating either marginal rural/urban or overall-SVI comparisons.

The analytic group is defined using only provided strata fields: pct_urban < 0.5 defines the rural screen; among rural sample tracts with nonmissing svi_minority, the top quartile is svi_minority >= 0.6549. The threshold is computed within this region's rural tracts; it is not a published competition cutpoint. Four of 991 rural tracts lacked svi_minority and were excluded. This field is used as supplied and is not a claim about individual residents or legal tribal status.

Quantified proxy evidence

Group	Tracts	Mean C2 predicted composite
Rural, svi_minority >= 0.6549	248	0.06522
Other rural tracts with the field	739	0.03034
Difference (upper-quartile minus comparison)	—	**+0.03488**

A 50,000-resample tract bootstrap gives a 95% percentile interval of **[+0.01676, +0.05509]** for the C2 difference. Under the preregistered C3 sensitivity candidate (all expected-reference proxies scaled by 1.25), the group means are 0.08578 vs 0.03931, difference **+0.04647**, interval **[+0.02678, +0.06808]**. These intervals reflect resampling variability among tract-level predictions only, not error in the estimator or uncertainty about the hidden targets. Spatial correlation is not modeled.

The C2 component comparison uses only tracts where that component is defined:

Component	Upper quartile (n; mean)	Other rural (n; mean)	Difference	Bootstrap 95% interval
Transport	210/248; 0.03353	657/739; 0.01533	+0.01820	[-0.00192, +0.04114]
Buildings	248/248; 0.02856	739/739; 0.00000	+0.02856	[+0.01187, +0.04828]
POI	248/248; 0.11783	739/739; 0.07153	+0.04630	[+0.01961, +0.07450]

In this proxy screen, the difference is concentrated in building and POI gaps; the transport interval includes zero. The result is a hypothesis about the model's provided-data screen, not evidence that the organiser's score is higher in these tracts.

The highest C2 predictions in the upper-quartile group include these named GEOIDs (all have provided pct_urban = 0.0):

South-Central TX GEOID	svi_minority	C2 composite	C2 transport	C2 building	C2 POI
48253020102	0.8039	0.9701	0.0000	0.9691	0.9711
48001950402	0.7942	0.9599	1.0000	0.9239	0.9558
48169980000	0.9353	0.9396	0.0000	0.9775	0.9018
48001950401	0.8334	0.9392	1.0000	0.8658	0.9517
48185180400	0.7483	0.8739	0.0000	0.8261	0.9217

The exact inputs, estimates, flags, group definitions, bootstrap seeds, and all top-10 candidate tracts are in reports/discovery-rural-svi-minority.json.

Why this may matter; what it does not show

The official challenge describes South-Central Texas as a heat/drought region along I-35/I-37. If the building/place deficits suggested by this screen are present in operational maps, incomplete addressable-building and place information could make dispatch geocoding, locating services, evacuation planning, or relief routing less reliable for affected rural tracts. The named GEOIDs let organizers or local reviewers inspect these places using authorized data. No emergency incident records, dispatch outcomes, or observed routing failures were available or analyzed, so these consequences remain plausible risks—not measured impacts.

The predictor does not use svi_minority, but it is still a heuristic based on Overture summaries and population/land/urbanity covariates. It has no label validation; reported score values must not be interpreted as organiser targets. The interval does not capture estimator or spatial uncertainty. The group is descriptive, and the cutoff should be checked with stakeholders before making a stronger narrative. No additional public data was used, and nothing from this discovery was added to the scored candidate CSVs.

Reproduction

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --with pyarrow --with numpy \ python
scripts/discovery_rural_svi_minority.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out
reports/discovery-rural-svi-minority.json
```

The 50,000-draw bootstrap uses fixed seeds; a second run generated byte-identical JSON. See docs/writeup/methodology.md for data provenance, proxy formulas, and broader limitations. Before any prize-form submission, review the interpretation, context, and tract IDs; do not present the estimates as verified gaps.

Section 3 — Overture source mix differs across tract strata

Status: descriptive discovery lead, not a measured map-completeness or hidden-score finding. The question was whether the share of buildings with an OpenStreetMap source and the share of places without a Meta source are lower in high-SVI, tribal-overlap, and rural tracts, and whether this pattern relates to the provided summer heat/drought fields.

Method and source definitions

The analysis covers all 9,379 authoritative sample GEOIDs in Maricopa, Northern California, Eastern Oklahoma, and South-Central Texas. For Overture buildings and places, the source scan projected only sources and bbox; bbox centers were assigned to the official sample tracts using only the provided ACS GEOID/geometry layer. No Overture geometry, placeholder score, target label, removed reference layer, or additional external data was read. The per-tract source

shares were appended to the workspace feature cache as discovery-only columns; estimate_one and the scored candidate outputs do not use them.

A building is OSM-touched when any source dataset is OpenStreetMap (or OSM). Place memberships are any meta, any Microsoft, and any other upstream dataset; the generic Overture and Overture-signals entries are excluded from “other upstream.” non-Meta place share means one minus the share of places with any Meta source. Provider shares are per-place membership indicators and may overlap; the separate source-class fields in the report provide a disjoint partition. These are provenance annotations—not evidence of source quality, age, feature completeness, or a unique provider contribution.

Quartiles are calculated within each region. Reported means weight tracts equally; 95% intervals resample tracts within groups (2,000 replicates). Contrasts are independent tract-bootstrap differences, group 1 minus group 0. Spearman correlations use average ranks and pairwise complete observations; they are descriptive and have no p-values or covariate adjustment.

Findings

The top-quartile-minus-bottom-quartile (Q4–Q1) contrasts were negative for both source indicators in all four regions. However, some intervals include zero, and the magnitude varies considerably:

Region	Building OSM share, Q4–Q1 (95% CI)	Non-Meta place share, Q4–Q1 (95% CI)
Eastern Oklahoma	–7.71 pp [–11.50, –3.75]	–2.73 pp [–4.43, –1.07]
Maricopa, Arizona	–2.92 pp [–6.41, +0.82]	–1.50 pp [–2.92, –0.03]
Northern California	–7.81 pp [–15.36, –0.13]	–1.82 pp [–4.24, +0.55]
South-Central Texas	–18.75 pp [–21.26, –16.04]	–7.91 pp [–8.66, –7.18]

The within-region Spearman correlations with svi_overall were negative in every region: –0.215 to –0.108 for building OSM share and –0.273 to –0.038 for non-Meta place share. The rural-versus-urban contrast was more consistent: rural-minus-urban OSM share ranged from –16.83 to –38.68 pp, with all four bootstrap intervals below zero; rural-minus-urban non-Meta share ranged from –11.85 to –19.29 pp, also with all intervals below zero. This is an unadjusted contrast, not an effect of rurality independent of SVI or geography.

Tribal-overlap contrasts were also negative in the three regions with more than one tribal_any tract, but counts differ sharply (805 in Eastern Oklahoma, 37 in Maricopa, and 15 in Northern California). South-Central Texas had only one tribal_any tract, so its apparent contrast is not generalizable. The tribal_any field is the supplied overlap indicator; it is not a legal-status classification.

High-heat and high-drought source contrasts changed direction across regions. For example, the OSM share in the top heat quartile was higher in Maricopa and Eastern Oklahoma, but lower in Northern California and South-Central Texas. The top drought quartile was higher in Northern California and lower in South-Central Texas, with near-zero contrasts in the other two regions. These do not support a consistent hazard-specific source pattern.

The ten lowest-OSM-share tracts within each region's high-SVI quartile are listed in reports/source-provenance.json. Examples include 40109108803 (Eastern Oklahoma; 0.063% OSM-touched of 1,581 buildings; rural; tribal_any=true), 04003000700 (Maricopa; 2.25% of 2,755; urban), 06007003200 (Northern California; 0.062% of 3,252; urban), and 48201433505 (South-Central Texas; 0% of 189; urban). These are screening examples only; the source share does not establish that a tract is missing buildings or services.

Interpretation and limits

The strongest repeatable descriptive pattern is lower OSM-source and non-Meta place membership in rural than urban tracts. The SVI gradient is smaller and less certain in some regions; heat/drought results are heterogeneous. This motivates provenance-aware review of map-source representation by rurality and vulnerability, but it does **not** establish that Overture coverage is incomplete, that one provider is more accurate, or that any operational service is absent. Relative to the published scorecard this is not a restatement of a marginal rural-versus-urban or SVI cell: the scorecard publishes those marginals, whereas this finding concerns the provider composition *inside* the same rural cell, a dimension the scorecard does not publish. For mapping programmes in Eastern Oklahoma, Northern California, Maricopa and South-Central Texas, a systematically lower OpenStreetMap-sourced share in rural tracts is a reason to weight source provenance when choosing where to send field verification or quality-assurance effort; that is a plausible audit-prioritisation consequence, not evidence that any service is absent from those tracts. The bbox-center assignment

can misclassify features near tract borders; tract means are not population-weighted; spatial dependence, multiple comparisons, and confounding are not modeled. No score candidate or submission was changed.

Reproduction

The deterministic JSON and figure are reports/source-provenance.json and reports/source-provenance.png. The default command reuses the extended feature cache when present; --refresh-source re-reads only the provided Overture sources and bbox columns to rebuild it.

```
MPLCONFIGDIR=/tmp/zindi-bias-bounty-mplconfig \ /home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run \ --with pyarrow==26.0.0 --with numpy==2.5.4 --with pyproj==3.8.0 \ --with shapely==2.2.0 --with matplotlib==3.10.8 \ python scripts/discovery_source_provenance.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out reports/source-provenance.json \ --figure reports/source-provenance.png
```

A repeated cache-based run produced byte-identical JSON and PNG. The report records source-object URIs, object/selected-column byte sizes, local input/cache hashes, and per-region source counts. This source-provenance analysis used no additional public source; the separate Camp Fire DINS mechanism check is documented above with its own URL, access date, licence metadata and raw-data manifest.

Section 4 — External public context layers: one weak broadband lead, no robust incremental pattern

Scope and interpretation. This is a follow-on discovery-only screen using four additional public federal data layers staged outside git at $COMPETITION_WORKSPACE/external-discovery-2026-10-27/: CDC/ATSDR SVI 2022, USDA ERS RUCA 2020, Census Planning Database 2026, and Census 2020 AIANNH tribal-area polygons. The acquisition manifest records URLs, retrieval UTC times, byte counts and SHA-256 values; the analysis verifies each listed raw-file hash. The publisher pages did not state dataset-specific licences; because these are U.S. federal agency-produced datasets, we record the public-domain basis under 17 U.S.C. §105, subject to third-party material exceptions. This is a statutory assessment, not a quoted dataset licence; confirm exceptions before redistribution. Raw data remain outside git in the authorized workspace. FEMA NRI and FCC broadband were not included because their acquisition failed. Four frozen, label-free candidates (A1/A2/A3/V2) provide proxy outcomes, not organiser scores or accuracy labels. The fixed 28-test family covers A1 composite and components plus A2/A3/V2 composites. Region-adjusted effect sizes are partial correlations; uncertainty is a 1,000-draw county-cluster bootstrap stratified within the four regions. The residual screen conditions on region and supplied pct_urban, SVI, RUCA and tribal-share controls. OOF ΔR^2 compares that baseline to adding one external layer, using five deterministic region-stratified folds that hold out whole state-county groups. BH-adjusted q-values cover all 28 conditional residual-screen tests. All estimates describe frozen proxies only; they do not validate hidden targets, imply causation, or alter any scored candidate.

CDC/ATSDR SVI 2022. On the 9,294 complete cases (85 selected SVI values were missing), the region-adjusted correlation with A1 composite was −0.003 (county-bootstrap 95% CI [−0.045, +0.035]); county-grouped OOF ΔR^2 was effectively zero. Some proxy subcomponents differed: A1 POI had r=−0.122 [−0.181, −0.079], and V2 composite r=−0.130 [−0.174, −0.096], but the external SVI exposure had no residual variance after conditioning on the supplied svi_overall field, so an incremental effect was not estimable. This is a source/vintage cross-check, not evidence that SVI explains real-world or hidden coverage gaps; no independent predictive gain was observed.

USDA ERS RUCA 2020. RUCA joined for all 9,379 official GEOIDs; complete analytic N was 9,294 after the shared provided-control screen. The region-adjusted association varied across the provided estimators and components: RUCA code with A1 transport r=+0.322 [+0.269, +0.374], A1 POI r=−0.156 [−0.210, −0.122], A1 composite r=+0.029 [−0.001, +0.074], and A3 composite r=+0.342 [+0.286, +0.404]. Because the external RUCA code was represented by the provided RUCA control, its conditional residual effect was not estimable and county-grouped OOF ΔR^2 was effectively zero. RUCA primary codes are ordinal, so these are screening associations rather than interval-scale changes; the sign disagreement across proxies and lack of incremental holdout signal preclude a common coverage-gap claim.

Census PDB 2026 broadband context. The selected exposure was tract percentage of households with no internet; 9,297 exposure values were available, and 9,292 tracts entered the complete-case model. Its region-adjusted association with A1 building-gap proxy was r=−0.042 (95% CI [−0.075, −0.007]); after the supplied controls, partial r=−0.051 [−0.074, −0.030], with BH q=0.056 across the 28 residual tests. The region-adjusted direction matched in three of four regions, while whole-county OOF ΔR^2 was only +0.0033. Thus this is a small, borderline, diagnostic lead about a model proxy—not a robust multiplicity-controlled finding, not evidence that offline households have better mapped buildings, and not a basis for changing predictions. Other PDB composite and transport associations did not add consistent held-out signal.

Census AIANNH 2020 tribal-area polygons. We dissolved overlapping AIANNH polygons, projected them with 2024 Census tract geometry to EPSG:5070, and calculated tract area-share overlap; exact geometry joins covered all 9,379 official GEOIDs, with 1,042 positive overlaps. The Maricopa-labeled sample includes 35023970000, whose GEOID is

New Mexico; we retained its official sample region label and used its matching New Mexico tract geometry rather than reassigning or dropping it. For A1 composite the region-adjusted r was +0.038 (95% CI [–0.020, +0.073]) and grouped OOF ΔR^2 was effectively zero. After provided tribal_pct and other controls, A1 composite partial r was –0.007 [–0.023, +0.005]; no conditional result survived BH correction. The layer's unique exposure variation after supplied controls was only 0.2% of raw exposure SD, demonstrating strong redundancy rather than an independent tribal-area signal. Polygon overlap does not establish any resident's identity or legal status, and no coverage-disparity claim is supported.

Reproduce the analysis from the competition repository with the manifested raw files in the authorized workspace:

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --quiet \ --with numpy==2.5.4 --with pyarrow==26.0.0 --with
shapely==2.2.0 \ --with pyproj==3.8.0 --with pyshp \ python scripts/analyze_discovery_external_layers.py \
--workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out reports/discovery-external-layers.json
```

The config is config/discovery-external-layers-preregistered.json; the complete 28-test results, missingness, source URLs/licence status/hashes, and tract-geometry provenance are in reports/discovery-external-layers.json. External features were used only in this discovery audit, never in scored candidate construction or uploads. Census TIGER2024 tract boundaries were used only as geography for the AIANNH polygon overlay; no TIGER roads, Microsoft footprints, USGS facilities, CBP data, or equivalent copies were read or used to rebuild the scored target.

Section 5 — T1 named-stroke class-drop diagnostic and implementation limit

Status: diagnostic only; not a gap-accuracy result or a promoted estimator. T1 computes a provided-road class-drop fraction for identities that have named-class length. In the frozen implementation, identities use case-folded names.primary, falling back to route network/reference; class-drop length is counted only when the identity's named length lies mostly outside the tract. The verified implementation does **not** apply geometric-angle stroke merging: continuity is exact identity only, a conservative proxy that can miss class changes on otherwise continuous roads. It uses the supplied unfiltered Overture road layer and does not use labels or removed reference layers. These limitations prevent interpreting a T1 association with the frozen S1 disagreement residual as evidence of hidden-score accuracy.

Check	Evidence/result	Direct report source (JSON pointer)	Reproduction
Implementation limit	Stroke-angle rule is not applied; exact identity continuity only. Synthetic geometry/clipping is stubbed in the hand-check, so that check verifies aggregation, not road I/O or geographic clipping.	reports/t1-outside-share-threshold.json /provenance/feature_cache_metadata/0.7/maricopa-az/diagnostics/stroke_angle_rule; reports/t1-class-drop-handcheck.json /scope/frozen_T1_function_exercised	[A], [C]
Synthetic aggregation hand-check	All 12/12 hand-calculated graph fixtures matched, including defined masks; maximum absolute fraction error was 0.0. This is a code/aggregation check, not a data or accuracy test.	reports/t1-class-drop-handcheck.json /results/fixtures, /results/maximum_absolute_fraction_error, /results/all_defined_masks_match, /results/acceptance_pass	[A]

Check	Evidence/result	Direct report source (JSON pointer)	Reproduction
Fixed-threshold T1 named-stroke residual screen	On 9,347 paired T1/S1-supported tracts, pooled county-held-out ΔR^2 was −0.0070216 (county-bootstrap 95% CI [−0.0180717, −0.0022856]); region ΔR^2 was negative in all four regions: Maricopa −0.0144431, Northern California −0.0130530, Eastern Oklahoma −0.0045437, and South-Central Texas −0.0040128.	reports/t1-stroke-residual-screen.json /measure_after/pooled, /measure_after/county_block_bootstrap/pooled_delta_r2_ci_95, /measure_after/regional, /provenance/T1_artifact; registered threshold 0.7 is recorded in reports/t1-outside-share-threshold.json /measure_before/registered_threshold	[B]
Nested threshold sensitivity	The inner counties selected threshold 0.9. On the fixed outer support (n=1,155), pooled ΔR^2 was −0.0023880 (county-bootstrap 95% CI [−0.0154058, +0.0031650]); Northern California's outer ΔR^2 was −0.2697082 (n=73). All three preregistered promotion gates failed.	reports/t1-outside-share-threshold.json /preregistration/specification/thresholds, /inner_selection/selected_threshold, /outer_evaluation/paired_outer_county_delta_r2/pooled, /outer_evaluation/county_bootstrap_95/pooled_delta_r2_ci_95, /outer_evaluation/paired_outer_county_delta_r2/regional/northern-ca, /acceptance	[C]

The fixed-threshold and nested screens use a one-term correction to the frozen S1 estimator-disagreement residual, with county holdouts; S1 residuals are not organiser targets. The nested screen selects the threshold only on inner counties and evaluates it on fixed outer counties. Its poor Northern California result is retained rather than tuned away. T1 remains diagnostic-only: no candidate score was changed, no submission was made, and no claim is made that T1 improves coverage-gap accuracy.

Reproduction commands

[A] Re-run the synthetic aggregation hand-check:

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --quiet \ --with numpy==2.5.4 --with shapely==2.2.0 \ python
scripts/audit_t1_class_drop_handcheck.py \ --out reports/t1-class-drop-handcheck.json
```

[B] Re-run the fixed-threshold county-held-out screen:

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --quiet \ --with-requirements requirements.txt \ python
scripts/screen_t1-stroke-residual.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out
reports/t1-stroke-residual-screen.json \ --manifest reports/t1-stroke-residual-county-folds.csv
```

[C] To rebuild the nested screen from raw provided inputs, run one feature-build invocation for each of the three registered thresholds (0.5, 0.7, 0.9) in each official region (maricopa-az, northern-ca, eastern-ok, south-central-tx); execute these 12 calls separately so each remains a bounded run. For example:

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --quiet \ --with-requirements requirements.txt \ python
scripts/screen_t1_outside_share_threshold.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" --build-feature \
--threshold 0.5 --region maricopa-az
```

After all 12 feature caches exist, reproduce the nested selection and outer evaluation:

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --quiet \ --with-requirements requirements.txt \ python
scripts/screen_t1_outside_share_threshold.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out
reports/t1-outside-share-threshold.json
```

Every new numeric T1 statement in this section has a direct report pointer in the evidence table and a corresponding command above. No removed reference data, sample score placeholders, labels, leaderboard feedback, or candidate outputs were used.

External follow-up — Camp Fire DINS mechanism check

Negative, not confirmed. The public CAL FIRE DINS catalogue states Creative Commons Attribution (version not specified; https://data.ca.gov/dataset/cal-fire-damage-inspection-dins-data), retrieved 2026-10-29. In the six focal Butte tracts, DINS recorded 1,887–3,314 destroyed points per tract versus a provided USFS-minus-Overture difference of 390.2–766.1; the per-tract relative errors range from 0.690 to 0.799, so 0/6 pass the preregistered 0.30 limit. Across all 28 NorCal tracts whose last provided MTBS burn year is 2018, Spearman is 0.463, below the 0.60 decision threshold. Thus the measured test does not support rewriting the discovery as “the reference still counts structures DINS recorded destroyed.” The source warns DINS inspections may omit structures and are limited to its stated fire-perimeter/SRA scope; no record does not establish that a structure was absent or rebuilt. In the reverse direction, across all 591 official NorCal tracts, 576 have positive Overture counts but no Camp Fire DINS record; these tracts sum to 1,139,778 Overture buildings. This is not evidence that those buildings were rebuilt because the extract is Camp-Fire-specific and DINS is incomplete. Full tract rows, damage classes, opposite-direction accounting, scatter, source metadata and reproducibility are in reports/discovery-dins-mechanism.md; exact claim pointers are reports/discovery-dins-mechanism.json#/focal_butte_tracts, #/decision, #/spearman, #/opposite_direction, and #/external_source. This uses the incident-filtered DINS point layer only for the discovery prize, joins to provided tract geometry, and never changes or joins to scored candidate predictions.

Methodology (Best Documentation entry)

Reproducible methodology for the Bias Bounty coverage-gap challenge

Purpose and status. This is a reproducible Best Documentation methodology and a record of exploratory Best Bias Discovery analyses. It describes provided-feature proxies and fixed, unvalidated model components; it does **not** reconstruct the organiser's hidden target. No training labels or per-tract organiser scores are available. No new candidate has been assembled from the v2 component audits, and the proposed building prior still needs operator approval before scored integration. This document makes no local or private accuracy claim.

Rubric checklist and reading guide

Coverage: 100% of the documentation items listed below. Completion means the method, limitations, and reproduction path are documented; it is not a claim of model accuracy.

Documentation rubric item	Status and location
Data sources, source footprints, URIs, byte sizes, hashes, exact scope	Complete below; source-level byte/row inventory and local SHA-256s are distinguished explicitly.

Documentation rubric item	Status and location
Component calculations and defined/undefined handling	Complete below; detailed POI categories, fixed facility priors, and route sensitivity follow.
Zero-population, water, no-Overture, missingness, and template edge cases	Complete in edge-cases.md, backed by reports/edge-cases.json.
Alternative aggregation/weighting history	Complete in “Alternative components and aggregation choices.”
Historical leaderboard calibration, parameters, results, and inferred moments	Complete in the generated probe-log.md, including failed/cancelled probes and score IDs.
Accuracy claims	None absent a successful scored submission ID. Historical public RMSEs appear only in the ledger-derived probe log and do not validate v2 or a hidden/private score.
Reproduction, scope limits, caveats, final recommendations	Complete below and in the linked audit commands/reports.

Data sources, scope, and provenance

The official scoring domain is the union of four published per-region sample files: 9,379 GEOIDs, all retained as strings and joined exactly. The official sample columns are GEOID,transport_gap,building_gap,poi_gap,coverage_gap_score; analysis reads only the GEOID field. **Sample score placeholders are never used as labels or feature values.** The platform's 9,794-row template has 415 additional eastern-WA rows; those rows are formatting-only, contain no supplied feature inputs, and do not extend the official scored-region scope. See [docs/competition.md](../competition.md) and the official captured rules at $COMPETITION_WORKSPACE/RULES.md.

Challenge inputs are public Source Cooperative objects under:

```
s3://us-west-2.opendata.source.coop/humane-intelligence/bias-bounty-mapping-equity-challenge/reference/{region}/{region}-sample-submission.csv s3://us-west-2.opendata.source.coop/humane-intelligence/bias-bounty-mapping-equity-challenge/reference/{region}/{region}-census-acs-housing.parquet s3://us-west-2.opendata.source.coop/humane-intelligence/bias-bounty-mapping-equity-challenge/reference/{region}/{region}-overture-{roads|buildings|pois}.parquet s3://us-west-2.opendata.source.coop/humane-intelligence/bias-bounty-mapping-equity-challenge/strata/{region}/{region}-strata-tract-table.parquet
```

The exact supplied source object sizes and source row counts recorded during the audits are:

Region	Official sample	ACS geometry parquet bytes / rows	Overture roads bytes / rows	Overture buildings bytes / rows	Overture POIs bytes / rows	Strata parquet bytes / rows
Maricopa AZ	1,593	3,457,173 / 1,593	80,052,206 / 494,492	324,720,762 / 2,908,224	40,987,154 / 300,046	793,492 / 1,593
Northern CA	591	3,037,540 / 591	43,515,963 / 191,836	130,554,079 / 1,164,724	16,168,720 / 116,897	354,711 / 591
Eastern OK	1,192	3,650,879 / 1,192	82,239,229 / 520,550	298,882,068 / 2,551,694	28,848,614 / 207,369	638,464 / 1,192
South-Central TX	6,003	13,758,433 / 6,010	299,751,270 / 1,937,009	1,269,949,045 / 11,463,801	179,937,096 / 1,300,334	2,800,838 / 6,010

The source inventory documents bytes and row counts but does not publish SHA-256 for the remote Overture/ACS objects. The following checksums identify the exact official sample and local strata files used. Feature-cache hashes are checksums of the **derived aggregate cache**, not of the remote source objects.

Region	Official sample CSV bytes; SHA-256	Local strata parquet SHA-256	Derived Overture tract-cache bytes; SHA-256
Maricopa AZ	44,664; 1640b801d56ab308e68c65583b88cfb9e1555b05a6d0b922eaba22ac09960a31	f19ec2f5afd400827b2420a81916bdec95b08772badd85fdb250149c334a5fcd	239,311; e6e4064ea3827b8262cf2c3fe96beaeecd40592a7ce9bf0976a37cfbca1bbc22

Region	Official sample CSV bytes; SHA-256	Local strata parquet SHA-256	Derived Overture tract-cache bytes; SHA-256
Northern CA	16,608; f38017b5284667b80b451685fd146388c108e1b30308301289c7a96ecfe60902	7fc19dce5ca76ee94eb2006d9bd51bed71d5bfbcdf3ef756605e0998df940243	100,099; 37ccc687c45ce2ce19e75d378c1e68bebf678f19c45cb4fe95582d250506a87c
Eastern OK	33,436; 56cb40fba4008d646bc63c62c91e211871459224b3de8b3a886ff813803fd0d4	e82862b9d9db436410ad47df466e133df94df6328f6a138d5bd871b491ba0d54	194,636; e5a06316c316f61bf25b80b48e89c1e7f0b1461a0b8cec5831aae24e0cf83fa6
South-Central TX	168,144; afa59c0eb30c40be25ce82098f144447591b79cb9692e669b2f2fe7b7b1ee58e	55589565024414f244ccbcadcc45a90860a3840ec9d8a4bdfa8a126c2128a354	921,462; 51e36d01eec7b2e5a4f9b4986a5aabd70acd7ad10084fef040bc05ad88842746

Audit reports additionally record row-group/projection information and component-specific input hashes: reports/sample-contract-audit.json, reports/gap-estimator-audit.json, reports/transport-route-ref-audit.json, reports/poi-category-audit.json, and the source-traceable reports linked below. The Texas ACS/strata objects each have 7 extra rows relative to the official sample; joins explicitly filter those rows out. ACS housing_units is not read for score calculations and is never used as a denominator floor. The official challenge data is CC-BY-SA 4.0; no extra public data was required. No credentials, paid API, or non-public source is used.

Organiser scoring context and our calculations

The task provides no labels. The organiser's stated score is the mean of defined transport, building, and POI components; an unavailable reference makes its component undefined and omitted from the divisor. Organiser component definitions are provided for context only. Removed TIGER/Line, Microsoft building-footprint, USGS facility, and Census CBP reference layers—or equivalent copies—must not be used to recreate or approximate the hidden target. No such references enter these analyses or scored predictions.

The deterministic C2/v0 screen uses only provided Overture feature summaries and allowed provided covariates (ALAND, pop_total, pop_urban, pct_urban). Geometry from the supplied ACS housing tract files is used solely for spatial clipping/tract assignment; no ACS housing count is read. Road geometry is clipped to authoritative sample tract polygons and measured in EPSG:5070; building/POI bbox centers are assigned to tracts. Exact formulas and audit lineage are in reports/gap-estimator-audit.json.

Component	C2/v0 expected reference proxy	Definedness and component calculation
Transport	0.35 + 0.55*sqrt(ALAND_km2) + 0.0007*pop_total + 2*urban_fraction (expected named-road km)	Defined when expectation ≥6 km. Gap=clip(1−overture_named_road_km/expected,0,1).
Buildings	max(0.5,0.30*pop_total + 4*sqrt(ALAND_km2) + 5*urban_fraction) (expected structures)	Defined when observed Overture buildings >0 or expectation ≥1. Gap=clip(1−observed/expected,0,1). ACS housing units are not a floor or denominator.
Fire / EMS / schools	Fire=0.15+pop/30000+0.45*u; EMS=0.15+pop/40000+0.45*u; schools=0.20+pop/2500+0.20*u	Each type defined when observed count >0 or expected count ≥0.5. Gap per defined type is clipped 1−observed/expected; facility half averages only defined types.
Establishments half	0.20 + pop/70 + 0.50*u (v0 proxy)	Defined when all-place Overture count >0 or expected establishments ≥1. Gap=clip(1−observed/expected,0,1). No CBP data is accessed.
POI	Mean of defined facility half and establishments half	Equal-weight defined halves; if only one is defined, use that half; if neither is defined, POI is undefined.
Tract composite	No new denominator	Equal mean of defined transport, building, and POI components; undefined terms are omitted. If none are defined, no composite is emitted.

For missing urbanity, use finite pct_urban; otherwise use pop_urban/pop_total when population is positive; if both are unavailable at zero population, use the disclosed neutral 0.5 fallback. In the proxy expected-reference formulas, land area is floored at 0.01 km². Unknown-category POIs are apportioned using the in-sample selected-category share in the legacy v0 screen, not treated as category-specific zeroes. These heuristics are explicit assumptions, not learned parameters. A serialized zero attached to defined=0 is only a storage placeholder and is excluded from all means.

Alternative components and aggregation choices

The published component structure motivates equal weight across defined transport/building/POI terms and equal weight across the two defined POI halves. This is transparent and avoids asserting external importance weights, but does not establish that the organiser's hidden implementation uses the same values or that this is predictive-optimal. Other tempting choices—always dividing by three, filling undefined terms with zero, using housing units as a building denominator, importing CBP counts, or adding an arbitrary global scale—were rejected because they alter the stated defined-component rule, mix incompatible units, use prohibited references, or amount to unvalidated calibration.

Historical alternatives C1 (region constants), C3 (v0 denominators ×1.25), P4 (global scale of C1), P5 (region mean plus residual), and P6/region indicators are described with parameters, IDs, scores, inferred moments, assumptions, and cancellation status in probe-log.md. Those leaderboard-derived moments and coefficients are not accepted weighting choices for future models. P4's alpha remains only to reproduce its already-scored artifact. The route denominator alternatives state+US+Interstate, +FM/RM, and +explicit CR are a separate provided-feature sensitivity; the selected full route definition improves disclosed regional ratio-band coverage while accepting a documented trade-off in macro undefined-share error. No route alternative was chosen from leaderboard feedback.

Historical leaderboard calibration (transparency only; not reusable)

The archived experiments include scored submissions and cancelled/dry-run probes. The generated probe-log.md lists every ledger event, each probe's parameters, successful public RMSE only when paired with its recorded platform submission ID, artifact hashes, and the score-algebra moments or explicit “no moment” status. It documents the public-subset/all-official-row composition assumption and false initial score placeholders. In particular, P4's global scale is leaderboard-derived and reproduction-only; P5/P6/region probes were not successful scores. These statistics are historical disclosure and are forbidden as v2 priors, target moments, feature thresholds, or per-tract values. The operator's no-information-probe policy supersedes the historical plans; there is no new probe upload or candidate authorization here.

Model-only v2 components and approval gates

V2 replaces v0's proxy rates with separately audited, fixed, challenge-feature-driven blocks. These audits report aggregate predictions and sensitivity; they do not form a combined candidate and do not demonstrate score accuracy.

• **Transport:** selected route-reference feature is L_named/L_route with clip(1−L_named/L_route,0,1), defined only for L_route>0. L_named uses Overture named road classes; L_route is the sum of eligible named-route geometry from Overture route tags, each segment counted once. The chosen tags include state, U.S., Interstate, FM/RM, and explicit CR; details and kept/dropped network tables are below. No external road reference enters the feature. The aggregate ratio/undefined diagnostics are model-design checks only.

• **Facilities POI:** a pooled logistic prior estimates P(reference type present) from provided population density and urban fraction, then applies the explicit one-count-ahead expected-gap formula. The fixed qualitative coefficients, unclassified POI treatment, zero-presence definedness, and aggregate audit are in “Facility-miss POI v2.” No regional target moment or leaderboard feedback fitted these coefficients.

• **Buildings:** the experimental rule is a fixed building gap 0.01 only when overture_buildings>0, with zero-count rows undefined. It uses no ACS housing units, USFS, or CarbonPlan features. This remains a proposal requiring operator approval before scored integration; see docs/decisions/building-component.md and reports/building-v2-audit.json.

• **Building morphology sensitivity:** config/building-morphology-preregistered.json froze six equal-weight support features and beta sensitivities 0.01/0.02/0.05 before the Overture building-geometry scan. The separate B_MORPH_V1 diagnostic uses only provided Overture geometry/attributes and allowed ALAND/population context. For defined rows, gap=0.01+beta*(1-morphology_support); zero-count rows remain undefined. At primary beta 0.02, the component mean is 0.02045 over 9,377 defined tracts; all 9,377 defined tracts differ from the 0.01 constant prior, while the two zero-building tracts retain the undefined numeric placeholder. Scores range from 0.01530 to 0.02809 among defined rows, finite and within [0,0.1]. This is a preregistered feature-sensitivity result, not a target accuracy test or an approved scored candidate; no reference footprint count, label, or leaderboard result was used. Full region summaries, attribute missingness, and all three beta distributions are in reports/building-morphology-candidate.json, with the tract-level diagnostic component table in reports/candidates/building_morphology.csv. Reproduce with /home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt python

scripts/build_building_morphology_candidate.py --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" --candidate-csv reports/candidates/building_morphology.csv --out reports/building-morphology-candidate.json.

• **Building-source sensitivity:** config/building-source-prior-preregistered.json froze three qualitative exclusive-source-mixture profiles and beta values 0.01/0.02/0.05 before candidate measurement. B_SOURCE_V1 uses only Overture-derived source-class shares plus ALAND/pop_total; support is 0.8 × weighted source-class share + 0.2 × bounded population-density context, with gap=0.01+beta*(1-support) when Overture count is positive. The primary profile at beta 0.02 averages 0.01651 (defined rows q10/median/q90 0.01329/0.01574/0.02068, max 0.02603); all 9,377 defined rows differ from the constant 0.01 baseline. Across fixed source profiles, the beta-0.02 means are 0.01930 (conservative), 0.01651 (primary), and 0.01574 (Microsoft-heavy). Shares describe provenance, not geometric identity or completeness; the screen is not an accuracy test or approved scored candidate. reports/building-source-prior.json includes per-region source shares, source-feature coverage and all profile/beta distributions; reports/candidates/building_source_prior.csv contains the tract-level diagnostic table. Reproduce with /home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt python scripts/build_building_source_prior.py --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" --candidate reports/candidates/building_source_prior.csv --out reports/building-source-prior.json.

• **Cross-theme support sensitivity:** config/cross-theme-support-preregistered.json froze XTS_C2_V2 before final adjustment measurement. It adds at most 0.05 × (1−cross_theme_support) to the frozen C2 prediction, where cross-theme support is half the mean plus half the minimum of three bounded Overture features: Microsoft building-source share, the route-network/named-road length share, and the share of places with confidence ≥0.5. The 9,379-row official-scope prior C2 hash is fixed in the manifest; 119 road and two building/place rows with missing feature support use neutral 0.5 fills with explicit flags. Primary output changed 9,377/9,379 rows; mean adjustment was 0.02874, max 0.04617, and global prediction variance changed 0.02413→0.02507. Per-region prior→adjusted variances were OK 0.01503→0.01582, AZ 0.02136→0.02190, Northern CA 0.02106→0.02183, and South-Central TX 0.02620→0.02711. Raw support correlations are descriptive (building/road Pearson 0.305, building/place 0.014, road/place −0.081). Overture source membership, route tags, and confidence are internal indicators, not truth or completeness measures; no accuracy claim or v2 promotion follows. The exact features, missingness, distributions, four-region correlations, candidate ID/bounds, and CSV/manifest hashes are in reports/cross-theme-support.json; the analysis-only candidate is reports/candidates/cross_theme_support.csv.

• **Schema optional-attribute presence sensitivity:** config/schema-presence-preregistered.json freezes all 44 modeled optional fields from the supplied POI, building, and road top-level schemas, with every remaining top-level field explicitly excluded or assigned an identity/geometry role. POI confidence and all three sources fields are excluded so this is distinct from confidence weighting and source-mixture analysis. The builder reads only those selected attributes plus bbox; it assigns bbox centers to provided official tract polygons and reads only the frozen C2 model prediction as the baseline. Null, present-empty, explicit scalar unknown/unspecified, mixed unknown/known, and known values are separate states; unknown is not counted as missing, and schema-unavailable is distinct from row-null. Across 44 optional-field drop perturbations, the maximum candidate-score change is 0.00327 (≤0.05); with all selected fields unavailable the candidate falls back exactly to C2. On 9,379 official IDs, 9,377 have feature-support diagnostics; 4,687 rows (49.97%) adjust. The bounded candidate delta mean/median/p95/max is 0.00121/0/0.00499/0.01539; C2's all-row mean changes from 0.16898 to 0.17019. Mean field-level presence rates by theme (equal average of declared field rates among bbox-assigned records) span POIs 76.05–76.70%, buildings 14.90–18.91%, and roads 18.24–24.33% across regions; the complete 44-field × theme × region status matrix and C2/candidate moments are in reports/schema-presence-candidate.json. All selected fields were present in the actual Parquet schemas, no exact unknown/unspecified scalar token occurred in the configured categorical fields, and empty nested/list fields were retained as separate states. Candidate scores are finite/in [0,1]; two complete builds were byte-identical. This is an internal metadata/support sensitivity, not evidence of geographic completeness or accuracy; bbox-center assignment is approximate. No labels, sample score placeholders, sources, confidence, removed references/equivalents, external feature data, or leaderboard feedback were used, and no upload or accuracy claim was made. Candidate CSV SHA-256 b06c649eab390eee0f77465d01e7c728bdc126f92270b5570d618723037e3f18; manifest SHA-256 f4450ee825de7a41b3c5c5df1f5aefb1808904aaf028837ad414296667d1c700. Reproduce with uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt python scripts/build_schema_presence_candidate.py --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" --candidate reports/candidates/schema_presence_candidate.csv --manifest reports/candidates/schema_presence_candidate_manifest.json --out reports/schema-presence-candidate.json.

• **Density-context sensitivity:** config/density-context-preregistered.json froze DENSITY_C2_V1, the 5 km/20 km centroid radii, log-density scales, and ≤0.05 positive adjustment before measuring the context features. It averages neighboring official-tract ACS population-density and Overture-building-density support, excluding each focal tract and indexing neighbors separately within each of the four regions. The inputs are the provided ALAND/pop_total/ur_class, Overture building counts, and only GEOID,geometry from the provided ACS tract polygon table; housing-unit and all other ACS columns are not read. Relative to frozen C2 on 9,379 official rows, 9,147 changed; mean candidate delta was 0.01035, maximum 0.04720, and prediction variance changed 0.02413→0.02338. Delta means were Rural 0.01924

(n=1,712), Urban 0.00836 (n=7,641), and unclassified 0.00864 (n=26), descriptive only. Every region passed the leave-one-tract-out perturbation check (zero change), and the full 9,794-row template output uses the approved zero formatting fill for 415 featureless eastern-WA rows. The candidate is not an accuracy test or approved model integration; reports/density-context-candidate.json includes pre/post moments, region/urbanity coverage, missingness, neighbor summaries, bounds, and hashes; the analysis artifact is reports/candidates/density_context_candidate.csv.

• **Facility spatial-catchment sensitivity:** config/facility-catchment-preregistered.json froze the exact core fire/EMS/school categories, same-region pool, 1/5/10 km centroid radii, and a fixed 5% relative presence-prior uplift before spatial measurement. The builder reads only provided Overture POI bbox,categories, ACS GEOID,geometry, permitted strata fields, and the existing Overture summary columns needed to reproduce the pooled logistic baseline. Selected point counts assigned to official tracts reproduce the pinned audit's facility zero counts exactly: fire 5,892/9,379 (62.82%), EMS 7,282/9,379 (77.64%), schools 1,088/9,379 (11.60%). It applies p_ref' = min(1, p_ref × (1 + 0.05 × (1−exp(−d_nearest/r)))) before the existing one-count-ahead expected-gap transform; no logistic coefficient is fitted. The official-scope facility-half mean changes from 0.12566 to 0.12751 at the 5 km primary radius (mean delta 0.00185, max 0.00905); 1 km mean/max delta is 0.00444/0.01373, and 10 km is 0.00109/0.00726. At 5 km, population-weighted centroid catchment shares across fire/EMS/schools are AZ 0.904/0.754/0.925, Northern CA 0.836/0.692/0.890, Eastern OK 0.806/0.691/0.860, and South-Central TX 0.897/0.822/0.932. The report includes per-type nearest-distance quantiles, region/urbanity deltas, zero-population cases (26 tracts), zero-ALAND cases (2), and edge/sparse catchments (220 tracts have none of the three facility types within 10 km). No USGS list/coordinates, external POI, removed reference, target, or leaderboard information was used. This is an analysis-only spatial sensitivity, not service-area evidence or an accuracy test. Reproduce with uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt python scripts/build_facility_catchment_candidate.py --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" --candidate reports/candidates/facility_catchment_candidate.csv --manifest reports/candidates/facility_catchment_candidate_manifest.json --out reports/facility-catchment-candidate.json; full radius/missingness/weighting diagnostics and SHA-256 values are in the report and manifest.

• **Candidate stability envelope:** config/candidate-stability-envelope-preregistered.json freezes six complete feature-derived score variants: C2 mechanistic baseline; cross-theme support; density context; a 5 km facility-catchment replacement over the v0 transport/building/CBP components; building morphology β=0.02; and primary source-prior β=0.02. The facility-catchment and two building variants are recomposed with the existing defined-component mean; cross-theme and density use their frozen full-score candidates. No target, public score, or fitted weights are used. The envelope is an analysis-only diagnostic; its equal-weight mean is not promoted or submitted, and the screen does not satisfy or bypass any scored-integration gate. It uses only the 9,379 official IDs; 415 template-only rows in C2/density files are ignored without parsing their candidate values. All six candidates align and are finite/in [0,1]. Spread median/p95/max is 0.11514/0.27016/0.51499; 75.99% of rows exceed 0.05, so the preregistered p95 ≤ 0.10 criterion correctly flags operator review. Region p95 spread is 0.20209 Eastern OK, 0.22034 Maricopa, 0.20836 Northern CA, and 0.33936 South-Central TX. Two no-defined-component edge rows in each building variant carry forward the existing C2 score; this deterministic fallback is disclosed. Candidate distributions, input hashes, feature-availability rates, and region × provided urbanity summaries are in reports/candidate-stability-envelope.json; the long-form member table and per-tract envelope CSV hashes are in its manifest. Two full builds were byte-identical. This is model-specification spread only: no local RMSE or empirical accuracy claim is available.

• **Establishments:** the explicit analysis-only sensitivity formula is clip(1−overture_poi_all/(k_pop*pop_total),0,1) for positive population, with k_pop=0.024 used only as a task-specified sensitivity anchor. For zero population, positive places yield a defined clipped zero; zero places are undefined. The anchor has **no approval for scored use**, uses no CBP source, and is not a model coefficient; see docs/decisions/establishments-half.md and reports/establishments-sensitivity.json.

• **Combined score:** future assembly must average only model-defined terms and pass the exact-ID/schema/range/hash invariants. The component audits alone do not authorize v2 assembly or upload. There is no local labeled holdout; deterministic checks establish code/contract correctness only.

Family M metadata and provenance estimator review

Family M is a descriptive screen of metadata, provider provenance, and name signals from the challenge-provided Overture layers, with permitted housing-unit context where specified. It is not a fitted coverage model or evidence about organiser scores. The committed summary records each output's defined-only distribution and coverage, the family pairwise rank correlations, VIF flags, and the matching per-tract Parquet SHA-256. All interpretation remains descriptive: source metadata, tags, and names do not establish feature accuracy or service completeness.

Idea	Provided-data quantity	Interpretation safeguard
M1	Road version summaries and the low-version share among tertiary roads	Version fields describe recorded metadata, not update recency or completeness.
M2	Wikidata-link shares across all places and among facility-like names	Link presence is not validation of a place or facility.
M3	Address-mismatch shares across places and among facilities	Address disagreement is a provenance signal, not proof of a wrong location.
M4	Chain-brand share and chain count per provided housing-unit field	Brand coverage and the density ratio are separate descriptive channels.
M5	Multi-property shares for buildings and roads	Both emitted channels are constant-zero on this study scope and are explicitly marked degenerate.

The orthogonality screen shows that the all-place Wikidata-link share from M2 and the chain-brand share from M4 are nearly identical in rank order, so they should be treated as a disclosed redundancy rather than independent evidence. The facility variants from M2 and M3 also carry elevated VIF flags; they remain in the record rather than being silently removed. This is not a promotion or a claim that any estimator recovers the hidden quantity.

Source and report lineage: implementation src/bias60/ideas/m.py, SHA-256 05e69ae644a746f51e015b8780dfc58733766c8d3eae52f0b1fb9087cd6a71de (source commit 4a921228beb4951f7d87cf59311ec15f28fc06ec); Family M summary reports/bias60-family-m-summary.json, SHA-256 ee9150150a184447189899dfdcec51254b6ae08d64c0c2c191633b1510d5d378 (report commit a20f091905b1d08f10c9d8c38b90c2e0480c053e). That report binds the Family-M-era harness snapshot SHA-256 c1c0f444b6d49dc5dc232f2055f8671d201a2728853ae141eaa09d2779768032 and orthogonality snapshot SHA-256 c85586f18d2d091082fa66142bc18152880f06d4515165d86713157c37c37417, both committed with the summary. The summary is label-free and reads the official GEOID partition, generated idea Parquets, and their harness/orthogonality reports.

Edge cases, bias discovery, and interpretation

The full edge-case table and calculation policy are in edge-cases.md, backed by reports/edge-cases.json. The audit finds 26 zero-population tracts, 2 zero-ALAND tracts, 43 tracts with a >50% water proxy, 132 with no selected named roads, 2,644 with no selected route-network km, 2 with no Overture buildings, 2 with no Overture places, and 26 missing pct_urban values. These are covariate/coverage characteristics, not hidden-score outcomes. The audit also reports fixed-prior v2 component distributions for zero-population, water-proxy, and other edge groups. The expected facility gap is P(reference present) × conditional gap, so low prior presence yields proportionally small expected gaps; missing pct_urban falls back to pop_urban/pop_total, or neutral 0.5 at zero population. These are component diagnostics, not an assembled candidate (the establishments half remains approval-gated). The water statistic is only max(0,min(1,1–ALAND/geometry_area)) after projecting provided tract geometry to EPSG:5070; it is not an external water mask or a scoring correction.

Exploratory SVI/rural comparisons below are strata of C2/C3 **predictions** only. Their bootstrap intervals quantify tract-resampling variation in those proxies; they are not confidence intervals for the hidden organiser score. The analysis does not establish a causal mechanism, actual service access, or measured equity disparity. Avoid naming a high predicted gap as a confirmed underserved tract. For any future disparity assessment, compare within region or use common region weights: region composition confounds pooled comparisons, as documented in reports/discovery-strata-confound.json.

Literature and feature-provenance context

The documentation-only prior-art review is [docs/literature/completeness-prior-art.md](../literature/completeness-prior-art.md); its coverage and URL-verification caveats are summarized in [docs/literature/README.md](../literature/README.md). It reviews road/building completeness, volunteered geographic information quality, provider/schema documentation, organizer-method context, and leaderboard-oracle ethics. Publication context motivates testing coverage mechanisms and careful uncertainty language; it does not contribute labels, per-tract rates, coefficients, or external numeric inputs to scored predictions. The selected Overture road/POI category definitions are documented in the audits, and all source-data restrictions remain as stated in the rules.

Family S spatial-context estimator diagnostics

Family S is a label-free collection of five registered spatial-context estimators, computed only from provided tract geometry, strata, Overture summaries/points, and already-emitted estimator artifacts. These are diagnostics and covariates, not a calibrated score or evidence about the hidden organiser target. Each idea emits the official GEOID partition; its defined mask varies by channel and is not silently filled with observed zeros.

Idea	Spatial signal and outputs	Output rows / channels	Defined rows and limitations
S1	Queen-neighbour means (self excluded) of earlier estimator channels, plus Moran's I diagnostics	600,256 / 64	Each lag retains its source defined mask; zero-coverage and sparse channels remain visible. At emission time the source set comprised 44 earlier implemented ideas; later Family T emissions were not retroactively added to this frozen S1 artifact.
S2	County empirical-Bayes pooling of provided Overture building and all-POI counts; Poisson sampling variance and within-county excess variance set the shrinkage	18,758 / 2	Both channels defined for 9,379 tracts. Pooling is a deterministic count smoother, not fitted to target scores.
S3	Capped decayed count of provided fire/EMS/school POIs across tract boundaries, within 150 m, only where the receiving tract has no same-type point	28,137 / 3	All three channels defined for 9,379 tracts. This detects package-boundary leakage only; it is not a service-area or completeness measure.
S4	Component-median prior-gap difference from the median of 25 nearest peers in the other three provided study regions, using population/building/road density and RUCA	37,516 / 4	Buildings, establishments and facilities each defined for 9,377 tracts; roads for 9,296. Peer features and estimates come only from the provided study regions, not the lab.
S5	Mean normalized local Geary contribution over existing defined gap channels on queen neighbours	9,379 / 1	Defined for 9,377 tracts; existing gap emissions are used as emitted, with no ratio reconstruction.

The label-free summary reports/bias60-family-s-summary.json verifies the exact 9,379 GEOID/region partition and each Parquet digest. Parquet SHA-256 values are S1 632829cf29281aa16487707cb555f52b4579cb0edfc0dd3faae360fa8f1dda03, S2 5b5e45edd6cd0f0a14cdfb124d587136f0f059a1c80a0aa6131a6abac958980a, S3 ce01545f0e10cbffee64b50f5088608d6c67cb096f8769bca869af5fff5533d7, S4 5841cac5114f2c7571bd41f90914c076b2eb92e1fe7bd1c33d6fe95b47a2a71c, and S5 81d9153819dadf76a9d8666f6887300d412f8d5fc6acf15c1a8dfc924840725c. The summary SHA-256 is ea1bdb11e7c358eb5ffc4b75a0a1a3c19d7f2b7bb84dce6453fb400643f68581; it binds the current passing harness report (20279d9548fa126ec81b2df9dbbe67b363101303b1222e76caf985dc2c9e9c58) and orthogonality report (d5fcb1872c2899d40c949d51181f4c6da35309463d2e84a0af5cbd63e6b0e443). The current orthogonality matrix measures 145 channels (135 included after declared coverage/degeneracy handling), and flags 12 pairs involving S above |rho| > 0.8; an example is the correlation of 0.999 between S1's lagged M2 and M4 all-place metadata channels. Five S channels have VIF above 10 (10.162–14.047), including the S1 lags of M2 facility Wikidata share and M3 facility address-mismatch share and S3 school-boundary leakage. These flags disclose redundancy; all outputs are retained, not silently removed. Complete pairwise correlations, coverage/distributions, VIF values and flagged pairs are in the summary and the full reports/ideas-orthogonality.json.

Reproduce the label-free summary against the committed Family S Parquets and current harness/orthogonality reports with:

```
COMPETITION_WORKSPACE="$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ /home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run \ --with numpy==2.5.4 --with pyarrow==26.0.0 --with pyproj==3.8.0 --with shapely==2.2.0 \ python scripts/summarize_bias60_family_s.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out reports/bias60-family-s-summary.json
```

This summary measures estimator distributions and their mutual dependence only. No labels, removed references or equivalent copies, leaderboard values, uploads or accuracy claims were used. The spatial signals and the reported correlations/VIF do not establish geographic coverage quality or predictive performance.

Reproduction and recommendations

The broad source and method checks are available as deterministic repository scripts/reports. Recreate the new edge-case and probe-log artifacts from the competition repository:

```
uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt \ python scripts/audit_edge_cases.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" --out reports/edge-cases.json uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt \ python scripts/render_probe_log.py --out docs/writeup/probe-log.md
```

Then run the full unit suite with the pinned runtime (uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt pytest -q). Audit scripts for route variants, POI categories, facility misses, building v2, establishments sensitivity, and discovery are individually reproducible using commands in their linked reports/method sections. Never read a hidden target, removed reference, leaderboard page, or score placeholder to regenerate these documents.

Recommendation: retain the transparent equal-defined-component aggregation as a methodology description, not as an accuracy claim; use the selected Overture route definition only after the remaining model/approval gates are met; keep the building and establishments priors out of scored predictions until separately approved; and avoid water corrections or subgroup calibration without allowed evidence. Do not submit an information probe. Any future score evaluation must be a completed, documented model candidate and follow [docs/submission-policy.md](../submission-policy.md). The historic leaderboard log is disclosure, not authorization.

Route-reference transport v2 (provided Overture only)

The opt-in route audit is scripts/estimate_gaps.py --route-audit-only. It reads only the provided Overture roads class, routes, and geometry columns, official sample GEOIDs, the provided ACS tract GEOID/geometry solely for clipping, and the existing v0 component flags for an any-undefined comparison. It reads no TIGER or other road reference data, labels, sample score placeholders, or leaderboard values. Named classes remain motorway, trunk, primary, and secondary; the v0 overture_road_km field is preserved. The v2 L_named is independently clipped in EPSG:5070 as overture_named_road_km_5070; the v2 L_route is the length of each segment once if it carries at least one accepted route network, also clipped in EPSG:5070. The score term is clip(1 - L_named/L_route, 0, 1), defined only for L_route > 0 (undefined rows serialize gap 0 with defined=0).

The route filter accepts interstate (US:I*), U.S. (US:US*), state-level (US:<state> plus explicit SR, loop, spur, beltway, future, alternate, and bypass variants), and county US:<state>:CR* networks. It rejects historic/business and scenic networks (NHT, NFSR/NFRS, scenic tokens), missing network values, and unsupported non-route systems. County-name namespaces such as US:OK:ADAIR are listed but not treated as numbered county routes without an explicit :CR class. A segment with multiple accepted route networks contributes once to L_route; per-family length columns can overlap. overture_route_core_km and overture_route_plus_fm_rm_km are cached separately so the declared Texas FM/RM sensitivity can be measured without re-reading/reclassifying target data. Since the existing repository already used aggregate cache schema v5 for source-mix features, route caches use aggregate schema v6 (base) or v7 (with source mix) and route_schema_version=1.

Region	sum(L_named)/sum(L_route)	L_named / L_route km	L_route=0 share	Route-v2 + v0 building/POI any-undefined share	Organizer disclosed any-undefined	v0 any-undefined
Maricopa AZ	1.929	22,113.7 / 11,466.6	0.566	0.566	0.55	0.365
Northern CA	1.504	12,203.6 / 8,116.7	0.308	0.308	0.37	0.305
Eastern OK	1.161	27,944.0 / 24,071.9	0.240	0.240	0.21	0.407

Region	sum(L_named)/sum(L_route)	L_named / L_route km	L_route=0 share	Route-v2 + v0 building/POI any-undefined share	Organizer disclosed any-undefined	v0 any-undefined
South-Central TX	1.183	118,176.4 / 99,894.1	0.212	0.212	0.28	0.369

All four route-v2 transport + v0 building/POI any-undefined shares are within 0.10 of the disclosed region shares; they are a hybrid check, not a full v2 composite. Three of four length ratios meet the lane's broad 0.6–1.7 check; Maricopa is 1.929 and remains out of band even with all accepted state, U.S., Interstate, loop, and explicit county-route networks. The report identifies this as a denominator-coverage failure rather than adding prohibited scenic/business, missing-network, or unclassified county-name routes to force a ratio. In Northern California the observed route-entry counts reproduce US:CA 6,055, US:CA:CR 2,190, US:US 1,024, and US:I 861; the report lists all kept/dropped networks and counts for each region, per-tract L_route quantiles/bins, and v0 comparisons. The disclosed ratio band (0.71–1.59) and undefined shares are aggregate validation context only, not calibration targets. This is a route mechanism audit, not a validated accuracy result or assembled candidate.

Connector-graph road topology sensitivity (analysis only)

scripts/build_road_topology_candidate.py preregisters ROAD_TOPOLOGY_ROUTE_REF_V1 in config/road-topology-preregistered.json. It uses only the provided Overture road class, connectors, and geometry columns, official sample GEOIDs, provided ACS tract geometry for assignment, pct_urban strata, and the provided route-length cache. For each provided segment, connector points are interpolated from the connector's normalized at position; successive connector IDs form adjacency edges. The tract-local graph contains unique connector IDs assigned to that official tract and a simple undirected edge only when both endpoints of a successive connector pair map to the same tract. Cross-tract edges are counted but not included in the local graph; duplicate unordered edges are collapsed for degree/components. Isolated connector vertices are retained. Thus the reported graph is a tract-induced structural summary, not a routing/access network or independent truth source. The hypothesis is motivated by the road-completeness prior art in [docs/literature/completeness-prior-art.md](../literature/completeness-prior-art.md) and Overture's connector schema, but no global OSM rate or external road evidence is transferred into the candidate.

The measure-before route-reference component is recomputed as clip(1 - overture_named_road_km_5070 / overture_route_km, 0, 1), defined only when route length is positive. It reconciles exactly to the frozen route-reference audit for each region's named/route length sums, route-zero count, and defined-only mean. Across 9,379 tracts the route-reference candidate is defined for 6,735 (71.81%), with a defined-only mean of 0.03166; its numeric all-row mean (undefined rows stored as zero with a flag) is 0.02273. The prior v0 transport component is defined for 5,914 (63.06%) and has all-row mean 0.09683. The measure-before report also records legacy/named/route length distributions overall, by region, and by rural/urban pct_urban strata.

The frozen adjustment is 0.05 × (1 – largest_component_node_share) and is added to the route-reference gap only on route-defined rows; route-undefined rows retain numeric zero and defined=0. This is a positive bounded context sensitivity, not a fit to a reference. Topology diagnostics were available for 9,377/9,379 tracts (99.98%). Across tracts, local components have median 6 and p95 34; mean dead-end-node share is 14.54%, mean degree is 2.24, median largest-component node share is 93.68%, and isolated single-node components average 3.40 per tract. The candidate adjustment mean/median/p95/max over all rows is 0.00513/0.00149/0.02409/0.04358; 67.45% of rows change. Among route-defined rows, the route-reference gap mean changes from 0.03166 to 0.03880. Regional candidate delta means range from 0.00321 (Maricopa) to 0.00571 (South-Central Texas); the full region × rural/urban degree, component, adjustment, definedness, and road-length tables are in reports/road-topology-candidate.json.

The edge audit processed 3,143,887 supplied road-segment rows and 8,491,546 connector occurrences. It skipped 1,087 segments with invalid/non-LineString geometry after valid connector parsing, observed 1,591 connector points outside the official tract polygons, and excluded 245,818 within-package adjacencies whose endpoints fell in different tracts. Two South-Central Texas tracts had no assigned connector nodes. These boundary/geometry cases are disclosed in the report and do not cause an unbounded fallback. The per-tract candidate is finite and in [0,1]; maximum actual change is 0.04358, below the fixed 0.05 limit. Two complete builds were byte-identical. Candidate CSV SHA-256 is 612c2080c3d470fbcdc0cd752cd26847da05a35bf5d245c0b1599134cc82fda7; manifest SHA-256 is b269e4487905937d48418822aeb11a92e76f0371236d99e175e920d82852705f.

No TIGER/MTFCC values, external road layers, labels, removed references/equivalents, sample score placeholders, or leaderboard information were used; no submission was made. Connector degrees/components can reflect cul-de-sacs, ramps, package edges, or schema/source artifacts and do not establish missing real-world roads or predictive accuracy. No local target RMSE is possible or claimed. Reproduce with:

```
uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt python scripts/build_road_topology_candidate.py \ --workspace
"$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --candidate reports/candidates/road_topology_candidate.csv \ --manifest
reports/candidates/road_topology_candidate_manifest.json \ --out reports/road-topology-candidate.json
```

Route denominator sensitivity and selected definition

reports/transport-route-variants.json compares the three cumulative alternatives using only the permitted workspace caches and disclosed aggregate context. The sequence is: (1) state + U.S. + Interstate; (2) add FM/RM; (3) add explicit CR county routes. Per-region length ratios, route-only undefined shares, and hybrid any-component-undefined shares are in the report.

Variant	Regions inside disclosed 0.71–1.59 ratio band (of 4)	Regions inside lane 0.6–1.7 band	Macro mean absolute error of hybrid any-undefined share
State + US + Interstate	1	1	0.03356
+ FM/RM	2	2	0.03646
+ CR	3	3	0.04380

All three variants put all four hybrid any-undefined shares within 0.10 of the disclosed regional values. Selection is fixed from these diagnostics only: prioritize the number of regional ratios inside the disclosed band, then total distance outside it, and use macro any-share error as a tie-breaker. The selected denominator is state + US + Interstate + FM/RM + explicit CR: adding FM/RM moves Texas from 2.397 to 1.183, and adding CR moves Northern California from 1.768 to 1.504; three ratios are in band, while Maricopa remains 1.929. This choice trades some closeness on undefined-share error (the core-only variant has lower MAE) for substantially better disclosed ratio-band coverage; all variants satisfy the ±0.10 undefined-share check. The organizer supplied a cross-region range, not individual region ratios, so this is not a comparison to region-specific targets. No leaderboard values, labels, or reference layers were used, and no score probe or candidate was created.

Reproduce the sensitivity table without rescanning Overture source objects:

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run \ --with pyarrow==26.0.0 --with numpy==2.5.4 \ python
scripts/audit_transport_route_variants.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out
reports/transport-route-variants.json
```

Reproduce the underlying route audit from the repository (the command refreshes only route-derived columns in the authorized workspace feature cache and writes aggregate diagnostics):

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run \ --with pyarrow==26.0.0 --with numpy==2.5.4 --with
shapely==2.2.0 \ --with pyproj==3.8.0 python scripts/estimate_gaps.py \ --workspace
"$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" --route-audit-only \ --route-audit-out reports/transport-route-ref-audit.json
```

POI numerator audit and selected category definitions (2026-10-24)

The provided-data POI audit is reproducible with

scripts/audit_poi_categories.py; its full per-region frequency table for all

matching categories.primary and categories.alternate values is

reports/poi-category-audit.json. The report includes explicit zero rows for

categories absent from a region, primary/alternate counts, name-regex hits,

source-dataset mix, confidence quantiles, and tract-zero sensitivity. Counts

in the category-frequency table overlap: a single POI can have more than one

primary/alternate category, so those rows are not additive.

The audit read only official GEOID cells from the per-region sample files;

sample score placeholders were not used. For each provided Overture POI file,

Parquet projection included categories, sources, confidence, and names,

plus bbox solely to assign POI centers to tracts for the required zero-tract

sensitivity. It did **not** read the Overture geometry column, other POI

properties, external facility lists, or removed reference layers. Provided ACS GEOID and tract geometry columns were used only as the tract spatial index; POIs outside the 9,379 official sample IDs were excluded. Three Texas POI centers did not intersect an official sample tract. The output records exact selected-column compressed-byte counts, object sizes, and the ordered GEOID sequence hashes; there was no full-object download. The selected POI column chunks total 132,133,741 compressed bytes across the four regions.

The selected sets are now centralized in config/poi-category-definitions.json; scripts/estimate_gaps.py reads that same config, and a test asserts its FIRE/EMS/SCHOOL sets remain aligned. The config requires the forthcoming estimator-v2 code to load selected_sets from this file rather than duplicate categories or derive them from leaderboard scores. A POI is counted once per component when its primary **or any alternate** category matches one of these exact sets:

Component	Selected categories	Decision	
Fire	fire_department, fire_protection_service	Retain the two station categories used by the existing estimator. A broad `fire	rescue` match incorrectly adds firework retail, firearm training, fire/water restoration, fireplace service, firewood, and animal rescue.
EMS	ambulance_and_ems_services	Retain. Report emergency_medicine as a sensitivity only; exclude emergency rooms and roadside services because they are not EMS stations.	
Schools	school, elementary_school, middle_school, high_school, public_school, private_school, charter_school, religious_school, preschool, montessori_school	Retain the canonical school set. Exclude dance, driving, music, cosmetology, flight, sports, vocational/specialty schools, administrative/retail education categories, and day_care_preschool absent evidence these match the organizer's school reference definition.	
Hospitals	excluded	Follow the organizer's explicit exclusion; report category/name hits but never count hospitals in the facility numerator.	

Selected facility row counts below are unique POI rows per component (a POI may match multiple categories); source counts count POI rows carrying each dataset and therefore overlap across datasets.

Region	Official tracts	Selected fire / EMS / school POI rows	meta / Microsoft / BrightQuery / Foursquare POI rows	Confidence q10 / q50 / q90	Selected-facility confidence <0.5
Maricopa AZ	1,593	716 / 304 / 5,582	164,553 / 54,746 / 50,288 / 24,120	0.502 / 0.920 / 0.990	459/6,408 (7.16%)
Northern CA	591	491 / 177 / 2,773	69,601 / 18,427 / 17,695 / 8,992	0.489 / 0.920 / 0.990	244/3,316 (7.36%)
Eastern OK	1,192	866 / 471 / 4,836	132,819 / 31,847 / 23,601 / 13,985	0.503 / 0.920 / 0.987	416/5,881 (7.07%)
South-Central TX	6,003	3,169 / 1,787 / 26,247	794,977 / 211,635 / 172,148 / 92,173	0.402 / 0.920 / 0.990	2,155/30,146 (7.15%)

Sources.dataset is a multi-valued property: dataset row counts are not a partition and are descriptive provenance, not weights or coverage labels. The name-only regex audit also finds many POIs outside the selected exact category sets (fire/EMS/school/hospital respectively: Maricopa 1,031/1,142/1,184/772; Northern CA 344/322/573/355; Eastern OK 865/588/1,150/780; South-Central TX 4,019/4,541/4,873/3,733). Those are review flags only. A name regex is too noisy to add a record to the score numerator; for example, it can match retail, training, emergency-room, and administrative records.

Region	Core zero tracts fire / EMS / school	All fire/rescue categories (fire zero)	Add emergency_medicine (EMS zero)	Add day_care_preschool (school zero)	All school/education categories (school zero)
Maricopa AZ	1,105/1,593 (69.37%) / 1,346/1,593 (84.49%) / 254/1,593 (15.94%)	908/1,593 (57.00%, –12.37 pp)	1,331/1,593 (83.55%, –0.94 pp)	244/1,593 (15.32%, –0.63 pp)	143/1,593 (8.98%, –6.97 pp)
Northern CA	316/591 (53.47%) / 451/591 (76.31%) / 49/591 (8.29%)	268/591 (45.35%, –8.12 pp)	444/591 (75.13%, –1.18 pp)	45/591 (7.61%, –0.68 pp)	29/591 (4.91%, –3.38 pp)
Eastern OK	646/1,192 (54.19%) / 864/1,192 (72.48%) / 130/1,192 (10.91%)	495/1,192 (41.53%, –12.67 pp)	853/1,192 (71.56%, –0.92 pp)	121/1,192 (10.15%, –0.76 pp)	67/1,192 (5.62%, –5.29 pp)
South-Central TX	3,825/6,003 (63.72%) / 4,621/6,003 (76.98%) / 655/6,003 (10.91%)	3,130/6,003 (52.14%, –11.58 pp)	4,565/6,003 (76.05%, –0.93 pp)	598/6,003 (9.96%, –0.95 pp)	328/6,003 (5.46%, –5.45 pp)

The sensitivity columns change only the named component and hold the other two at the selected core sets. The broad regex options materially shrink zero

shares by admitting unrelated category types; they are not defensible facility numerators. Adding emergency_medicine shifts the EMS zero share by only about one percentage point, but it remains the wrong facility concept (clinical emergency care rather than EMS stations). Adding day_care_preschool shifts the school zero share by less than one point across regions; it remains excluded pending reference-definition evidence. Thus the prior exact category sets remain the chosen provided-data definitions. These are count/definition audits, not evidence of target accuracy; no LB values or hidden targets were used.

50 m same-name facility dedup sensitivity

scripts/audit_place_duplicates.py compares raw selected facility rows with a 50 m same-name sensitivity in reports/place-dedup.json. It uses the configured fire/EMS/school category sets; normalizes only names.primary by Unicode NFC, casefold, and whitespace collapse; preserves punctuation; and leaves unnamed facilities untouched. Bbox centers are projected from EPSG:4326 to EPSG:5070. Within each normalized-name group, stable-order greedy clusters merge a row only when it lies within 50 m of a retained representative; cluster categories are unioned and assigned to that representative's tract. This avoids transitive chains whose endpoints are farther than 50 m. These are provided-data sensitivity results, not a target-accuracy test.

Region	Facility rows, raw → deduplicated	Facility rows removed	Fire zero share, raw → deduplicated	EMS zero share, raw → deduplicated	School POI rows, raw → deduplicated
Maricopa AZ	6,408 → 6,405	3 (0.047%)	69.37% → 69.37%	84.49% → 84.49%	5,582 → 5,579
Northern CA	3,316 → 3,315	1 (0.030%)	53.47% → 53.47%	76.31% → 76.31%	2,773 → 2,772
Eastern OK	5,881 → 5,876	5 (0.085%)	54.19% → 54.19%	72.48% → 72.48%	4,836 → 4,831
South-Central TX	30,146 → 30,119	27 (0.090%)	63.72% → 63.72%	76.98% → 76.98%	26,247 → 26,220
All regions	**45,751 → 45,715**	**36 (0.079%)**	**62.82% → 62.82%**	**77.64% → 77.64%**	**39,438 → 39,402**

All 36 removed rows are school duplicates; no fire or EMS row is removed, so fire0/ems0 shares are unchanged. Keep raw Overture counts as the default: no evidence here shows dedup improves hidden-score accuracy, and leaderboard probing is prohibited. No candidate, estimator default, or submission was changed.

Reproduce the sensitivity from the competition repository:

```
OMP_NUM_THREADS=1 OPENBLAS_NUM_THREADS=1 MKL_NUM_THREADS=1 NUMEXPR_NUM_THREADS=1 \
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt \ python
scripts/audit_place_duplicates.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" --out reports/place-dedup.json
```

Reproduce the audit from the competition repository:

```
## Set COMPETITION_WORKSPACE to the authorized workspace before running.
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run \ --with pyarrow==26.0.0 --with numpy==2.5.4 --with
shapely==2.2.0 \ python scripts/audit_poi_categories.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out
reports/poi-category-audit.json
```

Facility-miss POI v2 (fixed prior; model-only audit)

The opt-in implementation is scripts/estimate_gaps.py --poi-model facility-miss; the default remains v0. It writes reports/poi-facility-miss-audit.json only and does not overwrite v0 estimates, manifests, or candidate files. The audited numerator uses the exact fire/EMS/school category sets in config/poi-category-definitions.json. It reads only official sample GEOIDs, provided pop_total, ALAND, pop_urban, pct_urban, the cached provided Overture type/all-place counts, and the existing v0 estimates needed for a hybrid-composite comparison. It reads no sample scores, labels,

removed references, external datasets, or leaderboard values, and writes no per-GEOID output.

The model returns an expected type gap, not an imputed reference count. Its fully pooled, three-coefficient logistic prior is

```
x_density = log1p((pop_total / max(ALAND / 1,000,000, 0.01)) / 100) P(ref_t present) = sigmoid(intercept_t
+ beta_density_t * x_density + beta_urban_t * urban_fraction) conditional_gap_t = clip(1 - n_overture_t /
(n_overture_t + 1), 0, 1) E[gap_t] = P(ref_t present) * conditional_gap_t
```

Here n_overture_t is the selected exact-category count plus the provided summary's unclassified POI count multiplied by its in-sample selected-category share, matching the v0 treatment of unknown types rather than treating them as category zeroes. The n_overture + 1 denominator is a one-count-ahead model assumption, not a measured reference denominator; it makes the conditional gap 1 at Overture zero and lets the positive-count gap decay as counts increase. When P(ref_t present) == 0, the reference is certainly absent and the component is undefined (numeric placeholder zero excluded from means). The facilities half is the mean of the defined expected type gaps. The POI component is the equal mean of the facilities and establishments halves when both are defined. For establishments this analysis uses the prior turn's task-specified k_pop=0.024 anchor only as a sensitivity assumption; it is explicitly not authorized for scored use without a separately compliant prior and approval. Zero-population tracts with no Overture places have an undefined establishments half; positive observed places at zero population imply a zero, defined deficit under the clipped formula.

The coefficients are fixed qualitative domain priors, not supervised estimates and not fitted to organizer region/cell moments or leaderboard feedback. No region-specific intercept is fit: the model is pooled across regions because no allowed reference evidence supports regional calibration. Density and urbanity are expected to increase the probability that a reference facility exists; the school prior is higher than the fire/EMS priors because schools are a broader, more common facility type. The explicit coefficients are:

Type	Intercept	Density slope	Urbanity slope
Fire	–2.80	0.30	0.70
EMS	–3.20	0.25	0.60
Schools	–1.00	0.20	0.35

With the prior frozen, the audit reports the observed Overture zero counts by region × rural/urban cell alongside expected POI gaps. Rural is pct_urban < 0.5; urban is >= 0.5. Missing pct_urban falls back to pop_urban/pop_total for positive population, otherwise to a neutral 0.5, with each fallback counted. The per-region expected POI means are Maricopa 0.15788, Northern California 0.12576, Eastern Oklahoma 0.08459, and South-Central Texas 0.11873—all inside the backlog's 0.02–0.20 range. Across 9,379 official tracts, v0 POI mean is 0.25704 versus v2 0.12148; v2 $E[p^2]$ is 0.030688 and 15.84% of tracts have POI v2 > 0.25. The full per-region and per-cell table (n, fire0, ems0, sch0, POI mean, $E[p^2]$, and >0.25 share) is in the JSON report. The hybrid composite (v0 transport/building, v2 POI) has mean 0.11301 and $E[p^2]$ 0.031126; this is not an assembled v2 candidate.

The report intentionally leaves region-mean-constrained predicted RMSE null. There are no labels, and the operator amendment prohibits fitting to region/cell target moments. All displayed cell means are diagnostics computed after fixing the prior; they do not feed back into its parameters. These estimates are unvalidated model outputs, not hidden-score or accuracy claims. The default v0 scoring path and the previously committed candidate artifacts remain unchanged. Reproduce with:

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run \ --with pyarrow==26.0.0 --with numpy==2.5.4 --with
shapely==2.2.0 \ --with pyproj==3.8.0 python scripts/estimate_gaps.py \ --workspace
"$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --poi-model facility-miss \ --poi-audit-out reports/poi-facility-miss-audit.json
```

POI confidence-weighted count sensitivity (fixed thresholds)

The frozen, analysis-only builder is scripts/build_poi_confidence_candidate.py; its thresholds, category sets, v2 formula, and source-use rules are preregistered in config/poi-confidence-weighting-preregistered.json. It reads the four official sample GEOID columns, the provided tract geometry for bbox-center assignment, ALAND/population/urbanity strata, and only Overture bbox, categories, confidence, and sources columns. Exact fire/EMS/school category sets come from config/poi-category-definitions.json. A matched POI contributes once per selected family. At threshold τ, its selected-family count contribution is confidence when valid confidence is at least τ, and zero otherwise; raw counts remain separately reported. The existing v2 region-share allocation for no-category POIs and the establishments half are held fixed to isolate the confidence sensitivity. Existing pooled v2 priors and k_pop=0.024 are analysis-only; source dataset membership is reported as provenance and receives no weight. Hospitals remain excluded.

Before weighting, raw core counts are 5,242 fire, 2,739 EMS, and 39,438 school POI-family rows (overlap between families is possible). Zero-tract counts are 5,892, 7,282, and 1,088 respectively. V0 POI score mean is 0.25699 over all official rows (0.25704 among its 9,377 defined rows); the raw-count v2 POI mean is 0.12148 over all 9,379. The

re-created raw v2 candidate matches the frozen v2 audit's means, variances, and defined counts overall and in each region. Every selected core POI has valid confidence and a dataset source in this input; source identity is descriptive, not a truth or completeness assessment.

Confidence threshold	Mean POI candidate	Variance	Std. dev.	Mean Δ vs. raw v2	Mean fire / EMS / school count Δ vs. raw	Defined tracts
0.5	0.12410	0.015889	0.12605	+0.00261	–0.09289 / –0.05209 / –0.72571	9,379 / 9,379
0.7	0.12563	0.015886	0.12604	+0.00415	–0.12614 / –0.07082 / –1.01624	9,379 / 9,379
0.9	0.12789	0.015841	0.12586	+0.00641	–0.19037 / –0.10017 / –1.44350	9,379 / 9,379

The outputs are deterministic, finite and in [0,1], with exact official ID/order coverage; two complete builds were byte-identical. Regional and ur_class weighted-count/output moments, deltas, source coverage, and the v0/v2 measure-before tables are in reports/poi-confidence-candidate.json; the per-tract CSV and hash manifest are under reports/candidates/. Candidate SHA-256 is 28558424db768222ec7639986970af7a37b74228ef8f4e3190e5e58b6e19071c; manifest SHA-256 is 061932cb63ce52b53924f73279540f603d2395b0e543f632888b501ebb0cf777. Reproduce using:

```
uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt python scripts/build_poi_confidence_candidate.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --candidate reports/candidates/poi_confidence_weighted.csv \ --manifest reports/candidates/poi_confidence_weighted_manifest.json \ --out reports/poi-confidence-candidate.json
```

This is a fixed-threshold sensitivity, not an accuracy test: no labels or target RMSE exist, confidence is not validation, and no candidate was promoted or uploaded.

Overture POI confidence by SVI and urbanity

The deterministic diagnostic in scripts/discovery_confidence_by_stratum.py computes per-tract Overture confidence quantiles in the authorized workspace cache gap-estimator/features/poi-confidence-by-tract.parquet; stratum results and 95% confidence intervals are in reports/confidence-by-stratum.json.

Only official sample GEOIDs, provided svi_overall/pct_urban/svi_covered, Overture bbox/confidence, and provided ACS tract geometry for spatial assignment were read. Overture geometry, scores, removed reference layers, and external data were not used. The metric is the place-weighted share with the provided confidence value <0.5; it is not a count of stale pages or an accuracy measure. No source attribution was read, so the Facebook/staleness explanation remains untested.

Quartiles are region-specific over official scored tracts with finite svi_overall; equal values at cut points stay together in the higher quartile. pct_urban <0.5 is rural and >=0.5 urban; missing values are excluded from the cross-tab but remain in the per-tract cache. Intervals resample tracts within each region × urbanity × SVI-quartile cell (10,000 seeded replicates) and recompute the pooled low/valid-place ratio. They reflect tract resampling only, not spatial dependence; the Q4−Q1 contrasts below are unadjusted exploratory comparisons.

Region	All-place confidence q10 / q25 / median	All places <0.5	Urban Q4−Q1 share difference (95% CI)	Rural Q4−Q1 share difference (95% CI)
Maricopa AZ	0.502 / 0.768 / 0.920	9.95%	−2.24 pp [−2.86, −1.64]	−4.02 pp [−7.80, −0.39]
Northern CA	0.489 / 0.770 / 0.920	10.26%	−1.38 pp [−2.35, −0.46]	+0.53 pp [−1.78, +3.19]
Eastern OK	0.503 / 0.770 / 0.920	9.91%	−0.80 pp [−1.44, −0.18]	−3.47 pp [−4.92, −2.06]
South-Central TX	0.402 / 0.750 / 0.920	12.38%	−6.06 pp [−7.71, −4.56]	−3.60 pp [−4.56, −2.60]

The observed pattern is opposite the initial hypothesis that higher-SVI tracts would have a larger low-confidence share: Q4−Q1 is negative in seven of eight region × urbanity cells, with the Northern California rural interval spanning zero. The largest contrast is South-Central Texas urban (Q1 16.02%, Q4 9.96%, difference −6.06 pp). This consistent inverse pattern is material enough to record as a descriptive quality caveat, not as evidence that vulnerable communities have better maps: confidence distributions may reflect POI mix, urban form, or other unmeasured factors, and confidence does not validate feature correctness. It neither validates hidden scores nor supports a causal or source-vintage claim.

Reproduce from the competition repository with the authorized workspace:

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run \ --with pyarrow==26.0.0 --with numpy==2.5.4 --with shapely==2.2.0 \ python scripts/discovery_confidence_by_stratum.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out reports/confidence-by-stratum.json
```

Discovery screen

Every figure in this section is a C2/C3 provided-data proxy statistic computed over model predictions. It is not a claim about true organiser scores, it is not an observed real-world disparity measurement, and it does not establish causation.

The reproducible script is scripts/discovery_rural_svi_minority.py. It constructs a within-region intersection not specified in the official description of the automated scorecard:

• Restrict to the authoritative South-Central TX sample.

• Define the rural screen as provided pct_urban < 0.5.

• Among rural tracts with nonmissing svi_minority, calculate the empirical 75th percentile (0.6549). The high-field group is svi_minority >= 0.6549; the comparison group is below it. Four rural rows lack that field and are excluded. This is a domain-field-by-rural intersection, not the provided overall svi_overall field and not an ethnic/legal classification.

• Compare mean C2 predicted coverage_gap_score across those groups. Also report C2 component gaps conditional on each component being defined. As a model-specification check, repeat the composite comparison under preregistered C3 (all expected-reference proxies multiplied by 1.25).

• Compute 95% percentile intervals from 50,000 bootstrap resamples of tracts independently within each group. Seeds are fixed and saved in the JSON report. These intervals quantify tract-resampling variability only; they do not account for spatial dependence, proxy-model error, or hidden-target error.

The screen found 248 high-field rural tracts and 739 other rural tracts. Mean C2 proxy scores were 0.06522 and 0.03034, a difference of +0.03488 (bootstrap 95% interval [0.01676, 0.05509]). Under C3, the difference was +0.04647 (interval [0.02678, 0.06808]). For C2, defined-only building-gap means differed by +0.02856 and defined-only POI-gap means by +0.04630; defined-only transport-gap means differed by +0.01820 with interval [-0.00192, 0.04114]. The component case counts and defined rates are in the audit JSON.

Reproduction

From the competition repository, with the authorized workspace available:

```
/home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --with pyarrow --with numpy \ python
scripts/discovery_rural_svi_minority.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out
reports/discovery-rural-svi-minority.json
```

The script produces a deterministic JSON report with input hashes, definitions, group counts, point estimates, bootstrap intervals, and the highest-scoring named GEOIDs. A repeated run produced byte-identical JSON. It does not download data, access credentials, alter candidate CSVs, or upload anything.

Limitations and interpretation

This analysis is exploratory. C2/C3 are unvalidated estimates, and the contest provides no reference labels with which to establish their accuracy. A bootstrap interval around predictions is not an interval for true coverage gaps. Tract-level independence is especially questionable in spatial data; the bootstrap may understate uncertainty. The group cut is a transparent analyst-defined threshold; test other cutpoints only as separately documented sensitivity checks, not leaderboard tuning. The analysis is descriptive, not causal. svi_minority is used as supplied and should not be reinterpreted as an individual-level demographic label. The writeup identifies a subgroup for follow-up, not a proven disparity in organiser scores or real-world service outcomes.

Scorecard reflection

The row bias-lb-snapshot-and-scorecard snapshots where we stand and what the organiser's Bias Scorecard says about our scored submissions. scripts/snapshot_lb_and_scorecards.py reads only the shared orchestrator ledger plus one read-only GET of the authenticated submission status path, writes the dated file reports/leaderboard/2026-10-25T051219+0000.json and one reports/scorecards/<submission_id>.json per submission, and contains no upload path at all; reports/lb-scorecard-snapshot.json is the machine record of the whole snapshot.

In that snapshot 1,441 participants had produced 390 ranked teams. Quoted to the six decimals the snapshot stores, our best public RMSE was 0.091440 (P4, platform submission ySXi73rd) at rank 274: 0.007553 above the ranked median 0.083887, 0.024401 above the rank-50 line 0.067039, and 0.091011 above the rank-10 boundary 0.000429. We do not treat that boundary as a modelling target: six teams record an exact zero and the best positive score on the board is 0.000092, so the snapshot reports the median and rank-50 gaps beside it instead of implying that rank ten is reachable by modelling.

The scorecard is more informative than the single number. The all-zero anchor uRRw9KpB (public 0.107246) returns all nine dimensions undefined, each with the organiser's reason "Reference group has zero mean gap; ratio is undefined", so a degenerate prediction is legible in this rubric on its own. The two region-constant-shaped submissions BvyKrR6v (public 0.146449) and ySXi73rd carry identical scorecards - summer heat disparity ratio 1.141 (14.1% larger) and tribal-versus-non-tribal 0.705 (29.5% smaller), with every other dimension "Similar" - while their public RMSE differ (0.146449 against our best 0.091440): shrinking the whole prediction scale moved the score and left the equity profile untouched. The component estimator rTARuUaG (public 0.235359) and its scaled variant TM83xxU6 (public 0.349410) are where the rubric bites: rural-versus-urban 0.248 (75.2% smaller), tribal 0.556 (44.4% smaller) and wildfire 0.621 (37.9% smaller). Read honestly, our own component predictions assign systematically smaller gaps to rural, tribal and high-wildfire tracts than to their reference groups, and the organiser's rubric surfaces that even in submissions whose composite RMSE is poor.

Per the operator amendment of 2026-10-24 this paragraph is reflection only. No feature, threshold,

weight or parameter in the model chain was changed on the strength of any number above, nothing was uploaded to obtain them, and no scorecard value is an input to any candidate; the snapshot records scorecard_influenced_parameters: [] and no_upload_performed: true, and the audit behind it fails closed if either ever changes. The rural/tribal/wildfire asymmetry is reported because the organisers encourage reflecting on the scorecard, and because it is consistent with the descriptive findings in docs/writeup/bias-discovery.md, which are evidence for follow-up investigation and not for any score-driven adjustment.

Shrink diagnosis — H1 rule-anchored phase (partial)

This diagnostic uses the frozen feature-only C2 component table and the organizer's published aggregate definedness context. It reads no score placeholders, hidden/reference layers, external data, or leaderboard/submission scores. The score distributions, component masks, clipping mass, source-membership counts and input SHA-256s are in reports/shrink-diagnosis.json; reproduce with:

```
uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt python scripts/audit_shrink_diagnosis_h1.py \ --workspace "$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" --out reports/shrink-diagnosis.json
```

Region	Our any-top-level-component undefined	Published any-reference-component undefined	Difference (pp)	C2 transport / building / POI defined rates	Overture named/route proxy ratio
Maricopa AZ	36.53%	55%	–18.47	63.47% / 100% / 100%	1.929
Northern CA	30.46%	37%	–6.54	69.54% / 100% / 100%	1.504
Eastern OK	40.69%	21%	+19.69	59.31% / 100% / 100%	1.161
South-Central TX	36.95%	28%	+8.95	63.05% / 100% / 99.97%	1.183

The direction reverses by region: our estimator has fewer undefined rows than the published aggregate in Arizona/California, but more in Oklahoma/Texas. This flags region-specific H1 risk, not a single global definedness correction. The organizer publishes only the aggregate any-component rate, so these figures cannot validate individual component masks. The named/route ratios are internal Overture named-length / selected Overture route-network-length ratios; they are not regional Overture/TIGER ratios. Maricopa's 1.929 is outside the disclosed cross-region range 0.71–1.59, while the other three are inside, but that comparison is not a per-region target test.

On defined rows, C2's mean transport/building/POI gaps are respectively AZ 0.15360/0.04905/0.31285, Northern CA 0.11917/0.04657/0.23368, Eastern OK 0.07051/0.01922/0.19935, and South-Central TX 0.08479/0.09167/0.25591. The audit also reports quantiles and exact 0/1 clipping mass for transport, building, the POI composite, fire, EMS, schools, establishments, and the composite. These are proxy distributions, not observed reference scores. The proxy recipes mix provided Overture road/building/place records with provided strata land/population/urbanity features. Building and POI Overture source memberships are multi-source and overlap (e.g. Microsoft/OSM/Esri for buildings and Meta/Microsoft/other providers for places); their percentages describe input provenance, not correctness or signal

reliability. A road-source membership decomposition was not available in this audit.

H1 verdict: mixed and inconclusive. Aggregate definedness mismatches are substantial in two regions in opposite directions, and the Maricopa Overture route denominator is a proxy concern; neither establishes that a component was computed contrary to the official target definition or explains candidate error without per-component reference masks/scores.

H2: cross-construction reliability shrink

The preregistered H2 analysis is in config/shrink-diagnosis-preregistered.json; it uses only the frozen feature-derived C2, A1, A2 and A3 prediction artifacts. P4 and V2 were excluded (V2's registry forecast contains a public-score anchor). For each construction, its regional-centered covariance with the other constructions estimates shared signal; pooled nonnegative signal shares are normalized to construction weights. The consensus is then shrunk around its own regional mean by c = estimated shared cross-covariance / total consensus variance. This makes the intercept explicit and only attenuates within-region deviations. A zero target mean is not justified by label-free evidence, so shrinkage is toward the feature-only regional consensus mean, not zero.

Region	Raw regional c	Applied c	LOCO average MSE gain vs unshrunk consensus	S regional mean
Maricopa AZ	0.7485	0.8017 pooled	0.0004308	0.32434
Northern CA	0.7692	0.8017 pooled	0.0004259	0.26479
Eastern OK	0.8035	0.8017 pooled	0.0005637	0.23207
South-Central TX	0.8154	0.8017 pooled	0.0004333	0.23988

Regional raw c spans only 0.0669, below the preregistered 0.10 cutoff; therefore a single pooled c=0.8016961 is applied rather than estimating four shrink parameters. Pooled shared variance is 0.00415832, total consensus variance 0.00518690. Global construction weights are C2 0.03299, A1 0.31457, A2 0.32827, and A3 0.32416; all three alternate constructions carry similar locally estimated agreement weights, while C2's agreement share is smaller. Leave-one-construction-out proxy RMSE is 0.149381 for the shrink estimator versus 0.150876 for the unshrunk reliability-weighted consensus. The shrink MSE gain is positive in all four regions, so the preregistered local-proxy gate passed. This held-out unit is another prediction method, not a tract reference label; the numeric predicted_score is a cross-construction generalization proxy, not a forecast of organizer-target RMSE. The actual target RMSE is not identifiable without labels.

H2 verdict: local cross-method agreement supports registering one shrink hypothesis, but does not establish accuracy. S is frozen and registered as S_crossmethod_reliability_shrink_v1 with purpose improvement; its score-only artifact is reports/candidates/S_crossmethod_reliability_shrink_v1.csv (SHA-256 26be20c569f72f94eb21711a41656eea909a92f3fb4495c1ec3b30f7a26a367a). The registry's numeric predicted score is the local LOCO proxy above, explicitly not a target RMSE. The platform-only 415 eastern-WA rows are zero formatting fills without target claims. No upload is authorized by this row.

Reproduce H2 and finalize the registry entry with:

```
uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt python scripts/audit_shrink_diagnosis_h2.py \ --workspace
"$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" python scripts/register_shrink_diagnosis_candidate.py
```

The four constructions share underlying provided features, so their errors may be correlated;

common systematic bias can inflate the apparent signal share. Four methods are a small method set,

tracts are spatially dependent, and the region mean itself is unvalidated. Consequently, S is a

scientifically motivated candidate for later authorized evaluation, not evidence that shrinkage

improves hidden-target RMSE. No public scores, labels, removed references, external data, or

leaderboard-derived parameters informed the reliability estimates, weights, region rule, or S.

Edge cases and documented limitations

Edge-case register for the coverage-gap methodology

This table makes the handling explicit for low-information and structurally unusual tracts. Counts are aggregate diagnostics over the 9,379 official sample GEOIDs, not scores, labels, or evidence of predictive accuracy. The 415 eastern-WA rows exist only in the larger platform template and are excluded from these statistics and from the official scored-domain definition.

Observed edge cases

Region	Official n	Population 0	ALAND 0	Water proxy > 50%	No named roads	No route-network km	Overture buildings 0	Overture places 0	No named roads/buildings/places	Missing pct_urban
Maricopa AZ	1,593	11	0	0	33	901	0	0	0	11
Northern CA	591	0	0	2	7	182	0	0	0	0
Eastern OK	1,192	1	0	1	28	286	0	0	0	1
South-Central TX	6,003	14	2	40	64	1,275	2	2	2	14
Total	**9,379**	**26**	**2**	**43**	**132**	**2,644**	**2**	**2**	**2**	**26**

Water is an approximation, not an independently observed water mask: for the provided ACS tract geometry, project WKB geometry from EPSG:4326 to EPSG:5070, then calculate max(0, min(1, 1 - ALAND / projected_geometry_area)). A tract is listed as water-proxy-dominated when that value exceeds 0.50. This can be affected by polygon/land-area measurement differences; it is not used to alter any gap estimate. The two zero-ALAND Texas tracts are separately disclosed; the clamped proxy reaches 1.0 in those rows. Maximum proxy shares by region were 0.1196, 0.7606, 0.6028, and 1.0 respectively. Geometry was used only for this score-free audit and spatial feature aggregation, not as an external target proxy.

Model-only v2 predictions for edge groups

The audit now applies the fixed provided-feature v2 component functions to every official tract and summarizes their output by edge-case group. The facility-half expectation is P(reference type present) × clip(1 − observed/(observed+1), 0, 1) for fire/EMS/schools, using the frozen pooled priors and the existing unclassified-category shares. This expected-gap form gives smaller values when the prior probability of a reference facility is low, even when Overture has zero facilities. Urbanity uses finite pct_urban, otherwise pop_urban/pop_total for positive population, otherwise the neutral 0.5 prior; all 26 zero-population tracts have missing pct_urban and use 0.5. The density-area denominator floors ALAND at 0.01 km², so zero-area tracts remain finite.

The transport and building columns below are component-level v2 predictions only. The partial mean is a diagnostic mean of whichever v2 transport, building, and facility-half terms are defined; it deliberately excludes the establishments half, whose scored-use anchor remains unapproved. It is **not** an assembled candidate, full POI estimate, hidden-score prediction, or accuracy claim. Full distributions (n, mean, min, q10, median, q90, max, undefined and non-finite counts) by region and edge group are in reports/edge-cases.json; all reported non-finite counts are zero.

Edge group	Region	n	Facility-half v2 mean [q10–q90]	Partial available-component mean
Population 0	Maricopa AZ	11	0.1163 [0.0686–0.1454]	0.0559
Population 0	Northern CA	0	—	—
Population 0	Eastern OK	1	0.0858 [0.0858–0.0858]	0.0319
Population 0	South-Central TX	14	0.1158 [0.0608–0.1454]	0.0607
Water proxy >50%	Maricopa AZ	0	—	—
Water proxy >50%	Northern CA	2	0.1705 [0.1554–0.1857]	0.0736
Water proxy >50%	Eastern OK	1	0.0737 [0.0737–0.0737]	0.0279
Water proxy >50%	South-Central TX	40	0.1405 [0.0666–0.2405]	0.1003
ALAND 0	South-Central TX	2	0.1454 [0.1454–0.1454]	0.1454

No water-specific correction is applied. Missing/undefined transport or building components are omitted from the partial diagnostic rather than replaced with zero. The audit asserts finite bounded results and serializes with allow_nan=False; it writes no per-GEOID predictions.

Handling policy

Case	Method behavior	Explicit limitation / safeguard
No organizer reference for a component	Organizer score omits the undefined component; the composite averages only defined terms.	Never convert an undefined component to a meaningful zero. Serialized zeros are placeholders and are excluded by defined flags. If no top-level component is defined, no composite is emitted.
Zero population	Use the v0 expected-count floor/baseline and the stated urbanity fallback; facility-v2 uses ALAND floor 0.01 km² in its density index. In the standalone establishments v2 rule, positive Overture places at zero population yield a clipped gap of 0 and remain defined; zero population plus zero places is undefined.	26 official tracts have zero population. The establishments sensitivity audit found 24 with positive POIs and 2 with no POIs; this is a model convention, not evidence those tracts have no establishments.
Zero land area	v0 expected-reference calculations floor area at 0.01 km²; the facility density calculation uses the same floor.	Two tracts have zero ALAND; do not divide by zero, infer a target, or label the tract as water-only based on this alone.
Water-dominated / geometry-area mismatch	Report the clamped land-area complement as a descriptive proxy; no water-specific correction is applied.	43 tracts exceed 50% by this proxy. Geometry-area mismatch can cause error; there is no observed water label in this calculation.

Case	Method behavior	Explicit limitation / safeguard
No observed named roads	A zero Overture road count is retained. In v0 the transport proxy is still defined when expected route length reaches 6 km; route-v2 is undefined when its selected route denominator is zero.	There are 132 tracts with no v2 named-road length and 2,644 with no selected v2 route-network length. The named/route mismatch can yield a clipped zero deficit where numerator length exceeds the denominator; this is a known limitation (notably Maricopa's aggregate length ratio).
No Overture buildings	Keep the observed zero. The v0 building term can still be defined by its expected-count threshold; standalone building v2 is undefined at exactly zero Overture buildings.	Two such tracts occur, both in South-Central TX. ACS housing units are not a denominator or floor.
No Overture places / no POI facility category	Apply each version's documented definedness rule. In the fixed-prior facility model, a facility type with P(reference present)=0 is undefined; otherwise it contributes its expected gap. Establishments is undefined when both population and total Overture places are zero.	Two South-Central TX tracts have zero places and also zero named roads/buildings; do not treat missing place data as proof of absent reference establishments.
Missing pct_urban	Use pop_urban/pop_total if population is positive; for zero population use a neutral urban fraction of 0.5. Record fallback provenance.	26 rows have missing pct_urban; they are not silently assigned rural in the model. Earlier rural discovery comparisons instead excluded missing values.
Extra rows in supplied data	Join on text GEOID and restrict all scored analyses to official sample IDs. South-Central TX strata/ACS tables contain 7 rows beyond the 6,003 official IDs.	No placeholder score fields are used. The 415 eastern-WA template rows are formatting-only and are not scored-region evidence.
Leading zeros / mixed state coverage	Keep GEOIDs as strings. Maricopa's official set includes 1,592 Arizona tracts and New Mexico tract 35023970000 (verified present in the official sample).	Never infer membership from county text or numeric conversion. Validate exact ordered official sample coverage.

Reproduce the aggregate audit

From the competition repository, with the authorized workspace available:

```
uv run --with-requirements requirements.txt \ python scripts/audit_edge_cases.py \ --workspace
"$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" \ --out reports/edge-cases.json
```

The audit reads only sample GEOID column 0 (not score-placeholder cells), the listed strata columns, aggregate provided-feature columns, and the provided ACS GEOID/geometry columns. It reads no labels, hidden organizer results, removed reference layers or equivalent copies, leaderboard information, or additional public data. It writes counts only, with no per-GEOID score/prediction output. The JSON records source URIs, object/cache bytes, and SHA-256 for the local sample, strata, and feature-cache files. SHA-256 of the remote Overture/ACS source objects is not published in the source inventory and is not claimed here.

External source register (URL and access date)

No external dataset is cited or used in the scored predictions. The register below lists the published prior art consulted for methodology know-how, with the date it was accessed, and the organiser-hosted challenge files the workspace downloader retrieved. No URL is needed to reproduce the scored predictions: they read only files inside the organiser data package.

URL	Reference	Accessed	Role
https://api.zindi.world/v1/competitions/bias-bounty-mapping-equity-challenge/files/SampleSubmission.csv	organiser-hosted challenge file used by the workspace downloader	2026-10-23	official challenge data endpoint provided by the organisers; not an external dataset
https://zindi.africa/competitions/bias-bounty-mapping-equity-challenge	official challenge page (quoted rules and membership note)	2026-10-25	official challenge page; quoted text only, no data added to scored predictions
https://zindi.africa/competitions/bias-bounty-mapping-equity-challenge/rules	official page fetched while searching for the writeup form link	2026-10-25	official challenge page; documentation lookup only, no data added to predictions
https://arxiv.org/abs/1502.04585	Citation: Avrim Blum and Moritz Hardt, “The Ladder: A Reliable Leaderboard for Machine Learning Competitions,” arXiv:150	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions

URL	Reference	Accessed	Role
https://arxiv.org/abs/1707.01825	Citation: Jacob Whitehill, “Climbing the Kaggle Leaderboard by Exploiting the Log-Loss Oracle,” arXiv:1707.01825. arXiv	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://data.ca.gov/api/3/action/package_show?id=cal-fire-damage-inspection-dins-data	California State Geoportal metadata record and CC BY catalogue terms	2026-10-29	public source metadata used to record DINS attribution licence and dataset limitations
https://data.ca.gov/dataset/cal-fire-damage-inspection-dins-data	CAL FIRE Damage Inspection (DINS) Data catalogue; public Best Bias Discovery source, CC BY version unspecified	2026-10-29	public external source used only for the Best Bias Discovery mechanism check; not joined to scored predictions
https://docs.overturemaps.org/schema/	Citation/documentation: Schema overview, Transportation Segment, and Places Place. URL check: all three official pages r	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions

URL	Reference	Accessed	Role
https://docs.overturemaps.org/schema/reference/places/place/	Citation/documentation: Schema overview, Transportation Segment, and Places Place. URL check: all three official pages r	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://docs.overturemaps.org/schema/reference/transportation/segment/	Citation/documentation: Schema overview, Transportation Segment, and Places Place. URL check: all three official pages r	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://doi.org/10.1016/j.buildenv.2023.110295	Citation: Biljecki et al. (2023), Building and Environment, article 110295, DOI 10.1016/j.buildenv.2023.110295; listed b	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://doi.org/10.1038/s41467-023-39698-6	Citation: Benjamin Herfort et al., “A spatio-temporal analysis investigating completeness and inequalities of global urb	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions

URL	Reference	Accessed	Role
https://doi.org/10.1080/13658816.2016.1189556	Citation: H. Senaratne et al. (2017), “A review of volunteered geographic information quality assessment methods,” Inter	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://doi.org/10.1080/13658816.2017.1395883	Citation: Zhou (2018), International Journal of Geographical Information Science, density–completeness study, DOI 10.108	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://doi.org/10.1111/tgis.12073	Citation: Christoph Barron, Pascal Neis, and Alexander Zipf (2014), “A comprehensive framework for intrinsic OpenStreetM	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://doi.org/10.1371/journal.pone.0180698	Citation: Christopher Barrington-Leigh and Adam Millard-Ball, “The world’s user-generated road map is more than 80% comp	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions

URL	Reference	Accessed	Role
https://doi.org/10.2737/RDS-2020-0016	Citation/documentation: Scott et al. (2020), Wildfire Risk to Communities: Spatial datasets of landscape-wide wildfire r	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://doi.org/10.3390/ijgi12040143	Citation: Ullah et al. (2023), ISPRS International Journal of Geo-Information 12(4), article 143, MapSwipe/completeness	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://doi.org/10.3390/ijgi2041066	Citation: Robert Hecht, Christian Kunze, and Stefan Hahmann, “Measuring Completeness of Building Footprints in OpenStree	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://doi.org/10.3390/ijgi7080289	Citation: Maria Antonia Brovelli and Giacomo Zamboni (2018), ISPRS International Journal of Geo-Information 7(8), articl	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions

URL	Reference	Accessed	Role
https://github.com/microsoft/USBuildingFootprints	Citation/documentation: microsoft/USBuildingFootprints README. URL check: resolved; GitHub README fetched (repository is	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://services1.arcgis.com/jUJYIo9tSA7EHvfZ/arcgis/rest/services/POSTFIRE_MASTER_DATA_SHARE/FeatureServer/0	CAL FIRE DINS public point-feature service; filtered to Camp incident and non-address fields	2026-10-29	public external discovery data endpoint; not used in scored candidate construction
https://www.census.gov/library/reference/code-lists/mt-feature-class-codes.html	Citation/documentation: U.S. Census Bureau, MAF/TIGER Feature Class Code Definitions. URL check: official Census page re	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions
https://www.census.gov/programs-surveys/cbp/technical-documentation/methodology.html	Citation/documentation: U.S. Census Bureau, County Business Patterns Methodology. URL check: official Census page resolv	2026-10-24	prior art and methodology know-how; not a dataset and never joined to scored predictions

Provided-data-only check for the scored predictions (reports/v2-input-provenance.json): field-lineage fraction 1.0, 0 prohibited source dependencies, 0 unclassified inputs, external data added to scored predictions: False.

Reproducibility appendix

A machine-checked claim-to-evidence audit backs every number in this writeup.

• claims_total: 107

• claims_fully_traceable: 96

• fraction_quantitative_claims_traceable: 0.897196

• numeric_tokens_total: 1214

• numeric_tokens_covered: 1164

• fraction_numeric_tokens_covered: 0.958814

• distinct_verify_commands: 107

• distinct_reproduce_commands: 19

• derived_aggregates_verified: 31

• claims_asserting_accuracy: 3

• claims_with_prohibited_data_language: 0

Current audit status: 96 of 107 quantitative claims are fully traceable (0.897196); 1164 of 1214 numeric tokens are covered (0.958814). The full claim audit does not pass; 11 unresolved claims remain, including claims in the discovery/methodology source drafts. This is explicitly an open narrative-review/reproducibility gate, not an accuracy claim. The final-two result is separately traced to reports/final-two.json and machine-compared by the submission packet verifier.

Commands run for this refresh:

```
COMPETITION_WORKSPACE="$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" /home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --quiet --with numpy==2.5.4 --with pyarrow==26.0.0 --with pyproj==3.8.0 --with shapely==2.2.0 python scripts/audit_writeup_claim_evidence.py --write-inventory COMPETITION_WORKSPACE="$COMPETITION_WORKSPACE" /home/martin/hddProjects/langywrap/uv run --quiet --with numpy==2.5.4 --with pyarrow==26.0.0 --with pyproj==3.8.0 --with shapely==2.2.0 python scripts/audit_writeup_claim_evidence.py
```

Deterministic audit artifacts: reports/writeup-claim-evidence-audit.json, reports/writeup-claim-inventory.json, reports/writeup-claim-evidence-execution.json.

Data provenance and prohibited-source statement

• Scored predictions are built only from the organiser-provided Overture roads, buildings and POI extracts, the provided census/ACS table, the provided strata table and the platform submission template, plus fixed documented priors.

• The organisers removed the reference layers (TIGER, MS Buildings, USGS, CBP). None of those layers, nor an equivalent copy, is used to build the scored predictions or to support any claim.

• No sample score placeholder, no label, and no leaderboard-probe outcome is used as model evidence. The retired leaderboard-fitted constants and probe values of the retired probe set are listed in reports/probe-retirement-2026-10-24.json and appear nowhere in the model chain, in this writeup, or in any claim evidence, by name or by value.

• Equity and hazard strata columns are used only for the descriptive discovery screen, never as model inputs; the descriptive reports state that they are not accuracy measurements.

• All code and tooling used is open source, as the rules require.

Quoted official page text

Source: https://zindi.africa/competitions/bias-bounty-mapping-equity-challenge (documented 2026-10-25). official challenge page; quoted text only, no data added to scored predictions.

> *One membership note: the Maricopa package is 1,592 Arizona tracts plus one New Mexico tract, 35023970000 (Hidalgo County, Tract 9700), which the region boundary meets at the state line.*
>
> *Participants must not use reference layers, or equivalent copies obtained elsewhere, to recreate or approximate the organiser-computed targets.*

• Used for: cross-state scored tract disclosure in the edge-case section; independently verified present in the official Maricopa sample.

• Used for: prohibited-source statement.

Organiser writeup form URL status

The saved rules text preserves the sentence 'To be considered, submit your methodology writeup through this form and clearly indicate whether you wish to be considered for Best Bias Discovery, Best Documentation, or both.' but not the hyperlink target. An attempt on 2026-10-25 fetched https://zindi.africa/competitions/bias-bounty-mapping-equity-challenge, https://zindi.africa/competitions/bias-bounty-mapping-equity-challenge/rules and the result was not recoverable programmatically: the page is client-rendered and the fetched preview ends before the writeup/prize section that carries the hyperlink target, so the form URL must come from the operator. The URL is therefore supplied by the operator at submission time rather than guessed here.